

Actium Topco (UK) Limited

**Annual report and financial statements
for the period ended 31 March 2025**

Company number 15735478

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Company information

Directors	C J Kratz (appointed 22 May 2024) C H Welham (appointed 22 May 2024) J C Paton (appointed 19 August 2024) L M J Baqué (appointed 19 August 2024) D C Sladden (appointed 30 January 2025) J A W Gooze-Zijl (appointed 9 June 2025) I L Walsh (appointed 9 June 2025) C R Devereux (appointed 22 May 2024, resigned 19 August 2024)
Company number	15735478
Registered office	60 Gresham Street London EC2V 7BB United Kingdom
Independent auditor	KPMG LLP EastWest Tollhouse Hill Nottingham NG1 5FS United Kingdom

Strategic report

Principal activities

Actium Topco (UK) Limited (the "Company") is the holding company for a global group of companies (the "Group"), the principal activity of which is the provision of specialist consulting and related services to clients in the financial services industry

The Group operates across a number of boutiques

Asset & Wealth Management Delivering management consulting, technology consultancy and implementation services to the asset and wealth management sector	Alternatives Delivering management consulting, technology consultancy and implementation services to the alternative investments sector
Insurance Delivering management consulting, technology consultancy and implementation services to the insurance sector	Strategy & Deals Delivering specialist consulting solutions to the financial services industry's complex strategic challenges and opportunities
Agency Delivering specialist marketing expertise for the asset and wealth management and alternatives sectors	Aviq Delivering cloud-data analytics and managed data services to the asset and wealth management sector

Business review

The Company was incorporated on 22 May 2024, with capital provided by certain funds managed by Bridgepoint Advisers Limited, and subsequently commenced trading upon the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc and its subsidiaries ("Alpha") on 19 August 2024. Alpha is a leading global consultancy to the financial services industry, which was de-listed from the Alternative Investment Market ("AIM") shortly after completion of the acquisition. The £625.9m acquisition of Alpha was funded through a mixture of equity and debt. This has been a pivotal period for Alpha, with the investment by Bridgepoint representing a strong endorsement of Alpha's strength and future potential.

These consolidated financial statements for the period ended 31 March 2025 represent a short accounting period commencing on 22 May 2024, and reflect approximately 7.5 months of trading activity from the date of acquiring Alpha on 19 August 2024. No comparative period is presented as the Company was incorporated in the current accounting period. References to annualised figures relate to the performance of the acquired Alpha business for the full twelve months to 31 March 2025 (including the post-acquisition results of the Bankside and White Marble businesses acquired by Alpha during the year) and the preceding twelve months to 31 March 2024 (as reported in Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc's consolidated financial statements).

Strategic report (continued)

Business review (continued)

Key performance indicators	Period ended 31 March 2025
Revenue	£172.8m
Gross profit	£52.8m
Operating loss	£(10.3)m
Operating cash flow	£(8.7)m
Net assets	£195.8m
Headcount at the period end	1,236 consultants

The Group delivered a resilient performance in the period, generating revenue of £172.8m. On an annualised basis, revenue for the underlying Alpha trading group was £267.8m, an increase from £235.5m in the prior Alpha trading year. Gross profit for the short period was £52.8m, with a gross profit margin broadly consistent with Alpha's historical trading performance. The Group reported an operating loss of £10.3m, which includes £18.6m of amortisation on acquired intangible assets and £16.5m of one-off acquisition-related transaction costs. These transaction costs primarily comprise third-party adviser fees incurred in connection with the acquisition of Alpha. The loss before tax for the period was £43.5m after deducting net finance costs of £33.2m, primarily relating to interest on the Group's external debt facilities and investor loan notes. The Group's loss after tax was £41.8m.

As at 31 March 2025, the Group had 1,236 client-facing consultants (including contractors), an increase from Alpha's 1,000 consultants as at 31 March 2024. The Group also expanded its client base during the period, securing new engagements through both organic growth and strategic acquisitions.

The directors are satisfied by the Group's resilient performance and the growth in annualised revenue, particularly against an ongoing competitive market environment. Revenue growth has been anchored on some key achievements in the period, including the continued expansion of the Group's business model to cover a broader range of value propositions across geographies, acquisition activity, notable progress in cross-selling across divisions and markets, and the extension of certain client relationships from short-term projects into multi-year transformational programmes. Growth has been primarily driven by the established Asset & Wealth Management and Alternatives boutiques, with further contributions from the growing Strategy & Deals division, and the client data and analytics solutions division, Aiviq. Market conditions were more challenging in Insurance consulting, particularly in the UK, though the Group remains confident in the long-term potential of this sector, especially in North America. Group average consultant utilisation was below target levels globally on average for much of the period but improved to meet target levels by 31 March 2025. The Group's performance in the period demonstrates the resilience of its business model against an ongoing competitive environment.

The strength of the Group has also been enhanced during the period, to further serve its clients, through the acquisitions of Bankside and White Marble (now Alpha Agency), bringing world-class technology consulting and marketing expertise into the Alpha family.

Bankside is a UK-based technology consulting firm providing specialist data integration services to the asset and wealth management sector. The combination of Alpha's leading consulting capability for the asset and wealth management sector and the Bankside team's deep expertise and toolsets will enhance the Group's competitive end-to-end offering for clients through large-scale and complex technical technology implementations.

Strategic report (continued)

Business review (continued)

White Marble is a specialist marketing consultancy firm to asset management, wealth management and alternative investments clients. The addition of the White Marble team to the Alpha Group further extends the Group's specialist sector-focussed offering, allowing for a holistic range of client solutions from brand strategy to supporting go-to-market projects, to end-to-end digital and creative services support.

Further details on these acquisitions are set out in note 10 of the consolidated financial statements.

The Group reported a strong financial position at the period end with net assets of £195.8m. The balance sheet includes goodwill of £413.9m and intangible assets of £257.1m recognised in relation to acquisitions in the period. The Group's net debt as at 31 March 2025 was £426.1m, comprising £227.2m of external borrowings and £214.8m of investor loan notes (including accrued interest), partially offset by £15.9m of cash. Further details on the Group's borrowings are set out in note 17 of the consolidated financial statements. Working capital remained at satisfactory levels, although it widened through the period. Effective management of working capital continues to be a focus for the Group.

Overall, the performance of the Group demonstrates resilience in ongoing competitive market conditions. The acquisition of Alpha in the period demonstrates the directors' confidence in the deep-rooted specialism offered by the Alpha teams across the Group's client offerings, the strength of Alpha's market positioning, and its ability to deliver the Group's strategy in the medium to long term.

Strategy

The Group's strategic vision is to be the best consulting firm in financial services worldwide, covering all sectors, capabilities and major geographies. The strategy to achieve this is aligned to three broad pillars, as set out below, which aim to grow, optimise and diversify the business.

The Group is satisfied with the progress made against its strategic pillars during the period, as outlined below, and remains confident in its ability to build on Alpha's success going forward.

Strategic pillar	Progress in the period	Areas of focus
1. Scale up and broaden the Group's client proposition by adding services and consulting activities that together present a differentiated and more comprehensive offering	- Alpha's leadership continues to be strengthened, with 24 promotions to Partner / Senior Partner, and over 200 promotions in total across the organisation - Client engagements stretched from projects to programmes to multi-year transformations, with world-renowned managers - Established Alpha Agency, a dedicated brand, marketing and creative services boutique, following the acquisition of White Marble - The Group now comprises 1,236 consultants, including the addition of the Bankside and White Marble teams	- Targeted investment into the Group's capabilities across divisions - Deepen and extend the Group's Insurance consulting proposition

Strategic report (continued)

Strategy (continued)

Strategic pillar	Progress in the period	Areas of focus
2. Roll out the client proposition globally and progress opportunities to grow further within our markets	• Expansion of the Insurance consulting division in the North America market • Successful cross-selling of the 'best of Alpha' across divisions and practices to leading clients in the market	• Continued focus on North America with significant further opportunity ahead • Continued monitoring of opportunities for cross-border and cross-divisional selling
3. Make selective acquisitions	• The acquisitions of Bankside and White Marble in the period expand the end-to-end service offerings available to clients under the Alpha umbrella • The Group has developed a new corporate development function to support its acquisition agenda	• The Group continues to review acquisitions that can complement organic growth and maintains a healthy acquisition pipeline

Future developments

While the market environment continues to be competitive, the Group is well positioned to effectively pursue opportunities that support its long-term strategic goals. The long-term structural drivers of demand including growth in assets and insurance policies, regulatory demand, cost pressures, client and societal expectations, and technology breakthroughs continue to present significant growth opportunities for the Group in the medium to long term.

The Group's continued investment in its people and ongoing investment in expanding our service offerings, for example through recent acquisition activity, leaves the Group well-positioned to embrace these opportunities as they arise, with a specialist, experienced, and market-leading team available to deliver value to our clients across our divisions.

Looking ahead, the Group has developed an ambitious value creation plan aligned to its strategic vision. The plan focuses on executing the growth strategy through organic initiatives – growing, optimising, and diversifying the existing service offering – supplemented by targeted acquisitions.

The directors are confident of achieving this bold ambition and building on Alpha's outstanding positioning, offerings and people. The Group continues to navigate appropriately the rebalancing and improving consulting market conditions, and the Group remains confident of further growth with its multi-specialist model, strong track record and long-term perspective.

People

People are the Group's greatest asset, and we are very proud of the exceptional calibre and commitment of all our global teams. The quality of our people allows us to support and deliver some of the most complex and high-profile change and technology programmes within the financial services sectors that we support, and to retain a very strong reputation across a growing client base and in the markets in which we operate. In North America, Alpha was named one of the Best US Management Consulting Firms in Forbes' 10th annual report in collaboration with Statista.

Strategic report (continued)

People (continued)

During the period, since the acquisition of Alpha, the Group's headcount has increased organically and from acquisition activity. At the end of the period, the Group had 1,222 employees (including administration employees but excluding contractors), of which 139 were partners, providing an important layer of leadership of our growing consulting team and expertise. The Group places emphasis on recognising and rewarding its people through internal promotions, recognising the strength of internal talent and reflecting continued investment in talent development and progression.

We recognise the high performance of our team and incentivise them through a range of financial, operational and other people-orientated initiatives. Our culture is based on integrity, fairness, meritocracy and giving everyone the opportunity to feel they have a part to play in the success of the business. There are currently six employee community groups to support diversity, inclusion and belonging.

The Group is committed to ensuring equality of opportunity for all employees and applicants. Full and fair consideration is given to all applications of employment from disabled persons. Appropriate arrangements are made for all disabled person, including those who have become disabled during their employment. The Group is committed to the training and development of disabled persons and ensuring they have the access to the same opportunities as other employees.

The Group has a strong emphasis on employee engagement and feedback. Following an internal employee engagement survey conducted during the period, we were pleased to achieve an eNPS rating of "good". We were also pleased to have featured in the top half of the Best Large Companies to Work For and as a Top 5 Consultancy to Work For by Best Companies in the UK.

As the Group pursues an ambitious growth strategy, we remain very careful to consider and protect our unique expertise and culture.

Principal risks and uncertainties

The Group's business organisation, and the financial services industry in which it operates, expose it to a number of potential risks arising from internal or external events and actions. The Group therefore manages risk actively and closely in order to limit potential adverse effects on the implementation of its strategy, the financial performance and on the interests of its clients, employees and other stakeholders.

We are committed to evolving the business to remain resilient and successful over the long term, and we have therefore developed certain risk management objectives, which we continue to adhere to:

- Maintaining a strong corporate culture of risk awareness and responsibility embedded at all levels of the organisation,
- Mitigation of ongoing risk as far as possible, without unduly affecting the Group's competitiveness and flexibility, and
- Proactive identification and reporting of risk information, with clear management and mitigation responsibilities.

Strategic report (continued)

Principal risks and uncertainties (continued)

The Group operates an effective but streamlined approach to risk management. The Group follows a "top-down" and "bottom-up" approach to managing risks. Top-down strategic risk management is directed from the executive team and applied through the actions of the wider senior management, including regional leadership team and operational management. Bottom-up operational risk management is implemented through the engagement, risk awareness and corporate responsibility of all employees, supported by the Group's operations functions. It enables emerging risks to be assessed proactively and ensures that any risks that could impact the fulfilment of the Group's strategic ambition, including growth and diversification, are monitored and managed effectively.

These processes are further supported by relevant internal controls, scenario planning and regular risk reviews, which integrate external market insight with internal perspectives to ensure we maintain a clear and informed view of the risk landscape. As part of its risk processes, the Group also considers the most material current risks and uncertainties.

The table below outlines the principal risks faced by the Group and how they are mitigated.

Principal risk	Mitigating actions
Competitors Risk that a competitor or new entrant may be able to achieve success and win work from the Group's existing clients. Less mature or more specialist propositions, which the Group chooses to develop, may present less of a competitive advantage.	Continual development and investment in key competitive differentiators, including • Highly focussed sector proposition, working exclusively in asset and wealth management, alternatives and insurance sectors • Strong global reputation amongst clients, with the broad and deep expertise, and very high quality of the Group's teams as a key competitive advantage • In developing new specialist propositions, the Group leverages its strong global client relationships and extensive industry insights to earn competitive advantage from an early stage • Monitoring of the market to identify and assess any changes in competitive position, including growth rates and the link between demand and supply overall
Macro: Risk that wider market, economic, commercial and financial risks can impact the Group's ability to service clients, their demand for consultancy and technology services and, therefore, the Group's own performance and financial position.	• Monitoring of key business and growth activities within the Group's geographical locations and sectors, while consistently engaging with key internal stakeholders to identify, and plan around, significant trends or events • Regular horizon scanning to identify and assess emerging risks and to ensure an effective, coordinated response to any macro challenges that are identified • Business model that is responsive to change and regularly reviewed, and a proven record of developing the proposition successfully to anticipate and meet client needs • Ongoing diversification and expansion of the service offering, which can reduce the overall impact on the Group of particular restrictions or challenges in certain geographies or markets where the Group operates

Strategic report (continued)

Principal risks and uncertainties (continued)

Principal risk	Mitigating actions
Quality of service: Failure to maintain quality of service on client delivery engagements	- Clearly defined terms agreed up front, ensuring that each delivery framework is appropriate and the delivery objectives are achievable - Clear client account ownership structures to ensure accountability for client relationships, from opportunity generation, to ongoing monitoring of client satisfaction and fulfilment of agreed delivery criteria - Dynamic and integrated risk management framework, which encompasses service delivery oversight, to support the Group's focus on delivery excellence, early risk identification and promotes business collaboration on both opportunities and challenges - Close attention to client satisfaction and retention in the market, as well as the generation of re-sell and cross-sell opportunities, demonstrating the strength of the Group's full client proposition suite and consistency of reputation for quality across all business areas
People: Risk of failure to attract, incentivise and retain the best people with the right capabilities across all propositions, levels and geographies. A failure to undertake effective succession planning for key roles could also adversely increase this risk and impact performance	- Unique culture that values diversity, inclusivity, high performance, meritocracy, sociability, and support, accompanied by a broad and responsive support structure – incorporating HR, individual mentors, and external advice schemes – to ensure a continuous focus on our values and culture, alongside a robust set of policies - Rigorous recruitment process, which targets the highest calibre consultants in the industry, demonstrated through Alpha's record of attracting top talent versus the competition and increasing headcount - Competitive remuneration package with benefits for career development, recognition, and participation in profit-sharing or cash bonus - Extensive focus on retention, building capabilities, and providing targeted learning and development opportunities with a hyperfocus on support, career development, and effective succession planning

Strategic report (continued)

Principal risks and uncertainties (continued)

Principal risk	Mitigating actions
Business strategy: Risk that the Group responds inadequately to changing market factors, including technological advancements, and strategic growth opportunities, including acquisitions. The success of the Group depends on continuing to develop a proposition that best serves its clients.	• Strong visibility of market advancements and growth opportunities, enabled through an effective and coordinated director team working across multiple geographies and sectors, and a roadmap to increase the business both organically and inorganically • Proven ability, through Alpha's successful growth and expansion over 20+ years, to understand the structural drivers of the market, and to innovate and enhance the service offering accordingly, including the development of market-leading technology and data capabilities • Full acquisition due diligence and integration framework, including analysis, planning and mitigation as part of the upfront framework and dedicated integration projects with workstreams across business, commercials and operations for each acquisition • Continuous monitoring of the market for acquisition opportunities that would support the Group's strategy, positively enhance the offering and client satisfaction, and align with the Group's culture and values
Security: Risk of cyber-attacks, security breaches and data mishandling, leading to consequent risks to client data, loss of integrity or availability of core data.	• A comprehensive suite of data protection and information security policies, overseen by the Information Security function, to monitor and ensure compliance with processing agreements across key stakeholders and suppliers • IT Operations function collaborates with proficient external partners to facilitate the global delivery of the Group's internal and client-facing IT services • Best practice controls to prevent, detect and respond quickly to any cybersecurity events and data handling anomalies • Policies, processes, testing and training are in place to define the standards of control and educate staff on the operating context and potential risks, including the constantly evolving cyber risk landscape

In addition to the principal risks disclosed above, the Group is also exposed to other risks that are not considered principal risks. These include geopolitical, technological, regulatory, and financial risks. Further information on the Group's financial risk management is provided in note 22 to the consolidated financial statements.

Strategic report (continued)

Environment

As a professional services business, the Group's direct environmental footprint remains relatively low. Nonetheless, we recognise our responsibility to address climate change and environmental impacts more broadly, and continue to take practical steps to reduce emissions and embed sustainability across our operations.

In the period, the Group has strengthened the way it captures and interprets emissions data, enabling more comprehensive scope 3 reporting and providing a more robust basis for action. Rather than pursuing science-based targets or Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures ("TCFD") alignment at this stage, the priority is to establish a reliable emissions baseline and set out a clear path towards net zero.

The Group continues to reduce its emissions footprint wherever possible – working with landlords for leased offices to increase renewable energy use, encouraging low-carbon choices around travel, and introducing improvements in waste management. Where emissions cannot yet be avoided, we are transitioning from traditional offsets towards participation in the voluntary biodiversity and carbon markets ("BVCM"), aligning this with our broader community and charity partnerships for long-term, community-based impact. Our commitment to environmental transparency remains strong. While we no longer report via CDP, our EcoVadis submission has now been completed at a global Group level, with a score pending.

In parallel with internal efforts, our Environment, Social & Governance ("ESG") & Responsible Investment practice remains a key area of client work. Our consultants continue to support financial services organisations in shaping ESG strategies, navigating regulatory developments, and using technology and data to manage sustainability commitments effectively.

SECR disclosures

The following section sets out the Group's Streamlined Energy and Carbon Reporting (SECR) disclosures, including Group-wide energy use and emissions.

As noted previously in this strategic report, the Group acquired Alpha on 19 August 2024. Alpha is engaged in trading activities and is subject to energy and carbon reporting requirements. The Group itself did not undertake any business activity or consume energy prior to this acquisition. To provide meaningful, consistent and comparable SECR disclosures, information has been presented in respect of the underlying Alpha group for the full twelve-month period ended 31 March 2025. The accompanying commentary is also focused on changes since the previous full twelve-month period reported by Alpha. The directors consider this approach to provide a more complete and representative view of the Group's environmental impact. In addition, disclosures have been presented on a pro rata basis for the post-acquisition period, reflecting the Group's best estimate of its emissions and energy usage during that time.

Strategic report (continued)

SECR disclosures (continued)

Emissions

Scope	Activity	Full 12 months to 31 March 2025 for the underlying Alpha trading group			Pro rata for the period from 19 August 2024 to 31 March 2025		
		UK tCO ₂ e	Global excl UK tCO ₂ e	Total tCO ₂ e	UK tCO ₂ e	Global excl UK tCO ₂ e	Total tCO ₂ e
2	Purchased heat	7.4	21.3	28.7	4.6	13.1	17.7
	Purchased electricity	23.4	39.1	62.5	14.4	24.1	38.5
3*	Flights	391.0	1,090.0	1,481.0	240.6	670.8	911.4
	Public transport	197.4	294.6	492.0	121.5	181.3	302.8
	Taxis / car mileage	26.7	110.7	137.4	16.4	68.1	84.5
	Working from home	142.7	178.8	321.5	87.8	110.0	197.8
	Employee commuting	197.4	294.6	492.0	121.5	181.3	302.8
	Purchased goods & services	512.5	790.5	1,303.0	315.4	486.5	801.9
Total		1,498.5	2,819.6	4,318.1	922.2	1,735.2	2,657.4

* Scope 3 emissions reported in the table above exclude emissions from waste and some business travel

Energy

Scope	Activity	Full 12 months to 31 March 2025 for the underlying Alpha trading group			Pro rata for the period from 19 August 2024 to 31 March 2025		
		UK MWh	Global excl UK MWh	Total MWh	UK MWh	Global excl UK MWh	Total MWh
2	Purchased heat	44.5	104.2	148.7	27.4	64.1	91.5
	Purchased electricity	160.8	114.4	275.2	99.0	70.4	169.4
Total		205.3	218.6	423.9	126.4	134.5	260.9

Intensity metric

Scope	Activity	Full 12 months to 31 March 2025 for the underlying Alpha trading group			Pro rata for the period from 19 August 2024 to 31 March 2025		
		UK	Global excl UK	Total	UK	Global excl UK	Total
2 & 3	£m of revenue	116.7	151.1	267.8	75.3	97.5	172.8
	tCO ₂ e per £m of revenue	12.8	18.7	16.1	12.2	17.8	15.4

In the full twelve-month period ended 31 March 2025, Alpha's total carbon footprint increased 9.8% from 4,805 tCO₂e in FY24 to 5,279 tCO₂e (including waste and all business travel), reflecting both continued business growth and enhanced reporting boundaries. Two new scope 3 categories – purchased goods & services and waste – account for a large portion of the total emission increases, which are included this year, demonstrating our commitment to strengthening transparency and aligning with leading reporting frameworks such as the GHG Protocol and SECR guidance. The increase in emissions intensity (tCO₂e per £m revenue) was primarily driven by this rise in absolute emissions alongside a continued increase in revenue and headcount, both indicators of our expanding operations.

Strategic report (continued)

SECR disclosures (continued)

Scope 2 emissions decreased year-on-year, despite Alpha's growth. This improvement was underpinned by a combination of factors:

- A switch to greener energy sources, including increased use of district heating and cleaner purchased heat, replacing natural gas systems – resulting in a significantly lower emission factor per kWh
- Reduced office energy use in markets like the US, where sustained hybrid working patterns continue to reduce on-site energy consumption
- Cleaner electricity grid mixes in key locations such as the UK and France
- A shift to market-based electricity reporting, which, although showing a reduction in renewable electricity usage by around 10.5%, increased transparency and accuracy. Notably, total electricity consumption dropped by just over 30.0%
- It's important to note that no Scope 2 emissions were reported based on "area" and pre-calculated emission figures this year, which marks a considerable increase in data quality

In parallel, we significantly improved the accuracy and quality of our data. Compared to previously, where scope 2 estimates were often based on area or proxy data, we have now incorporated site-specific kWh consumption, contributing to both more accurate reporting and the observed decrease in emissions.

We also refined how we categorise scope 3 emissions. For instance, business travel data now comes from a single, consolidated source, eliminating potential duplication and enabling clearer categorisation between flights and other travel. This methodological improvement contributed to an apparent reduction in emissions from business travel, despite a modest 7.6% year-on-year increase in activity.

Other notable scope 3 changes include:

- Employee commuting emissions increased by 13.7%, reflecting more days spent in the office and a reduction in remote working patterns
- Fuel- and energy-related activities (FERA) emissions fell by 27.7%, due to improved emission factors and methodology, underpinned by more accurate consumption data and a stronger renewable energy mix

While Alpha's overall emissions have grown in line with its business expansion, the enhancements in data quality, methodology, and categorisation provide a more transparent, comprehensive, and actionable emissions profile – laying a stronger foundation for future reduction efforts.

Strategic report (continued)

Section 172 statement

Under Section 172(1) of the Companies Act 2006, a director of a company must act in the way that they consider, in good faith, would be most likely to promote the success of the company for the benefit of its members as a whole, and in doing so have regard (amongst other matters) to

- The likely consequence of any decision in the long-term,
- The interest of the company's employees,
- The need to foster the company's business relationships with suppliers, customers and others,
- The impact of the company's operations on the community and the environment,
- The desirability of the company maintaining a reputation for high standards of business conduct, and
- The need to act fairly between members of the company

The following disclosures describe how the directors have had regard to the matters set out in Section 172(1)(a) to (f) and forms the directors' statement under Section 414CZA of the Companies Act 2006

Engagement with key stakeholders

The directors consider the Group's key stakeholders to be its investors, lenders, employees, clients and the communities in which it operates. The board also recognises other stakeholder groups including suppliers, industry bodies and competitors. Engaging effectively with all these stakeholder groups strengthens the Group's business relationships and decision making and, therefore, supports its long-term success.

Stakeholder	Reasons for engagement	Stakeholder key interests	Methods of engagement
Investors	• Ensure alignment of expectations and strategy • Support sustained value creation and capital returns	• Financial performance and capital returns • Sustainable growth • Strong governance and stewardship	• Monthly board meetings • Involvement in key strategic decision making • Periodic portfolio reviews
Lenders	• Maintenance of an optimal capital structure • Borrowings provide liquidity to support the Group's ability to continue as a going concern	• Financial stability and liquidity • Timely repayment of interest and principal	• Annual presentation by the Group's CEO / CFO • Monthly financial reporting • Ad hoc correspondence

Strategic report (continued)

Section 172 statement (continued)

Stakeholder	Reasons for engagement	Stakeholder key interests	Methods of engagement
Employees	• Attracting, retaining and developing talent is essential to the Group's success • The Group is committed to providing a highly rewarding workplace and maintaining a strong, meritocratic, and inclusive culture	• Career progression and development • Engagement and feedback • Reward and recognition • Wellbeing, health and safety • Diversity and inclusion	• Employee feedback and success frameworks • Mentor programme • Training opportunities • Company meetings • Competitive remuneration packages • Diversity and inclusion programme and networks
Clients	• Helping clients to address challenges and capitalise on opportunities is core to the Group's proposition • Building long-term client relationships supports sustainable growth and strengthens the Group's market position	• High-quality deliverables that meet commercial objectives • Efficiency and value for money • Long-term partnerships to help shape clients' businesses for the future	• Senior level client relationship management • Continuous client satisfaction monitoring • Dialogue and round table discussions • Publication of market and industry insights
Communities	• Supporting community development aligns with the Group's values and growth objectives • Promoting positive social and environmental impact through responsible business practices • Engaging with local organisations to identify opportunities for meaningful contribution	• Responsible business practices that minimise harm and maximise positive impact • Meaningful and transparent engagement • Commitment to environmental sustainability and climate action • Support for local causes, charities, and community initiatives	• Diversity and inclusion programme and networks • Energy and carbon reporting • Carbon reduction and offsetting initiatives • Charity of the Year programme • Modern Slavery Statement and Living Wage accreditation • Tax evasion, anti-bribery and whistleblowing policies

Strategic report (continued)

Section 172 statement (continued)

Key board decisions

The key board decisions and considerations in the period to 31 March 2025 were as follows

Date	Board decision	Considerations
May 2024 / August 2024 / January 2025	Appointment of the Company's directors	To provide effective leadership that will support the sustainable, long-term success of the Group
August 2024	Approval of the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc	- To leverage the strategic benefits of combining Alpha's and Bridgepoint's expertise to support the Group's growth plans - To support Alpha's management and employees in growing the business and continuing to deliver an exceptional service for its clients
September 2024	Approval of the acquisition of Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited	To enhance the long-term growth and success of the Group by incorporating Bankside's complementary client base and employee skill sets
September 2024	Approval of the acquisition of White Marble Group Limited	To enable the Group to broaden its service offering to clients by adding branding and marketing expertise
January 2025	Establishment of the Group's new management incentive plan ("MIP")	- To provide senior employees with a competitive remuneration package - To drive long-term value by aligning the incentives of senior employees with investors

This report was approved by the board of directors and signed on its behalf by

J C Paich
Director
30 June 2025

Directors' report

Results and dividend

The Group made a loss of £41.8m for the period ended 31 March 2025. A review of business for the period is included in the strategic report.

No dividends were paid or declared in the period. The directors do not recommend the payment of a final dividend in respect of the period ended 31 March 2025.

Directors

The directors that served in office during the period and up to the date of approval of this report are as follows:

C J Kratz (appointed 22 May 2024)
C H Welham (appointed 22 May 2024)
J C Paton (appointed 19 August 2024)
L M J Baque (appointed 19 August 2024)
D C Sladden (appointed 30 January 2025)
J A W Gooze-Zijl (appointed 9 June 2025)
I L Walsh (appointed 9 June 2025)
C R Devereux (appointed 22 May 2024, resigned 19 August 2024)

Directors' indemnity provision

As permitted by the Articles of Association, the directors have the benefit of an indemnity, which is a qualifying third-party indemnity provision as defined by Section 234 of the Companies Act 2006. The indemnity was in force throughout the period and at the date of approval of this report.

Going concern

The directors have considered the Group's and the Company's ability to continue as a going concern and are satisfied that it is appropriate to prepare the financial statements on a going concern basis. Further detail is provided in note 1 of the consolidated financial statements.

Political donations and expenditure

The Group did not make any political donations or incur any political expenditure in the period.

Financial instruments

The Group's objectives and policies in relation to financial risk management, including its exposure to credit risk, liquidity risk, and market risk, are set out in note 22 to the consolidated financial statements.

Matters covered in the strategic report

In accordance with Section 414C(11) of the Companies Act 2006, the directors have chosen to include certain disclosures in the strategic report as they consider them to be of strategic importance to the Group. These include information on the Group's principal activities, business review, future developments, engagement with employees and suppliers, and environmental matters.

Directors' report (continued)

Auditor

In accordance with Section 485 of the Companies Act 2006, KPMG LLP has been appointed as auditor of the Company and the Group for the first financial period

Disclosure of information to auditor

Each of the persons who are directors as at the date of approval of this report confirms that

- So far as the director is aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the Company's auditors are unaware, and
- The director has taken all the steps that they ought to have taken as a director in order to make themselves aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the Company's auditors are aware of that information

Events after the reporting period

After the reporting period, in June 2025, the Group acquired Auxo Solutions LLC, a leading technology engineering company specialising in modern enterprise solutions, cloud, data and AI for the financial services industry. To fund the initial cash consideration, the Group drew down \$40.0m (£29.4m) on its acquisition debt facility. It also drew down further amounts on its revolving credit facility, with £9.6m outstanding under this facility as at the date of the approval of this report.

Also in June 2025, the Group entered into derivative financial instruments to manage its exposure to rising interest rates on borrowings.

Further details of these events after the reporting period are provided in note 26 of the consolidated financial statements.

This report was approved by the board of directors and signed on its behalf by



J C Paton
Director
30 June 2025

Statement of directors' responsibilities

The directors are responsible for preparing the strategic report, the directors' report and the Group and parent Company financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations

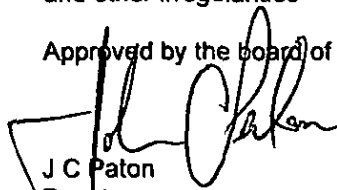
Company law requires the directors to prepare Group and parent company financial statements for each financial year. Under that law they have elected to prepare the Group financial statements in accordance with UK-adopted international accounting standards and applicable law. They have elected to prepare the parent Company financial statements in accordance with UK accounting standards and applicable law (UK Generally Accepted Accounting Practice), including FRS 101 *Reduced Disclosure Framework*.

Under company law the directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the Group and parent company and of the Group's profit or loss for that period. In preparing each of the Group and parent company financial statements, the directors are required to

- Select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently,
- Make judgements and estimates that are reasonable, relevant, and reliable and, in respect of the parent Company financial statements only, prudent,
- For the Group financial statements, state whether they have been prepared in accordance with UK-adopted international accounting standards,
- For the parent Company financial statements, state whether applicable UK accounting standards have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements
- Assess the Group and parent company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern, and
- Use the going concern basis of accounting unless they either intend to liquidate the Group or the parent Company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so

The directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the parent Company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the parent Company and enable them to ensure that its financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They are responsible for such internal control as they determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and have general responsibility for taking such steps as are reasonably open to them to safeguard the assets of the Group and to prevent and detect fraud and other irregularities.

Approved by the board of directors and signed on its behalf by



J C Paton
Director
30 June 2025

Independent auditor's report to the members of Actium Topco (UK) Limited

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of Actium Topco (UK) Limited ("the Company") for the period ended 31 March 2025 which comprise the Consolidated statement of comprehensive income, Consolidated balance sheet, Consolidated statement of changes in equity, Consolidated cash flow statement, Company balance sheet, Company statement of changes in equity and related notes, including the accounting policies in note 1

In our opinion

- the financial statements give a true and fair view of the state of the Group's and of the parent Company's affairs as at 31 March 2025 and of the Group's loss for the period then ended,
- the Group financial statements have been properly prepared in accordance with UK-adopted international accounting standards,
- the parent Company financial statements have been properly prepared in accordance with UK accounting standards, including FRS 101 *Reduced Disclosure Framework*, and
- the financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) ("ISAs (UK)") and applicable law. Our responsibilities are described below. We have fulfilled our ethical responsibilities under, and are independent of the Group in accordance with, UK ethical requirements including the FRC Ethical Standard. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is a sufficient and appropriate basis for our opinion.

Going concern

The directors have prepared the financial statements on the going concern basis as they do not intend to liquidate the Group or the Company or to cease their operations, and as they have concluded that the Group and the Company's financial position means that this is realistic. They have also concluded that there are no material uncertainties that could have cast significant doubt over their ability to continue as a going concern for at least a year from the date of approval of the financial statements ("the going concern period").

In our evaluation of the directors' conclusions, we considered the inherent risks to the Group's business model and analysed how those risks might affect the Group and Company's financial resources or ability to continue operations over the going concern period.

Our conclusions based on this work

- we consider that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate, and
- we have not identified, and concur with the directors' assessment that there is not, a material uncertainty related to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the Group or the Company's ability to continue as a going concern for the going concern period.

However, as we cannot predict all future events or conditions and as subsequent events may result in outcomes that are inconsistent with judgements that were reasonable at the time they were made, the above conclusions are not a guarantee that the Group or the Company will continue in operation.

Independent auditor's report to the members of Actium Topco (UK) Limited (continued)

Fraud and breaches of laws and regulations – ability to detect

Identifying and responding to risks of material misstatement due to fraud

To identify risks of material misstatement due to fraud ("fraud risks") we assessed events or conditions that could indicate an incentive or pressure to commit fraud or provide an opportunity to commit fraud. Our risk assessment procedures included:

- Enquiring of directors and inspection of policy documentation as to the Group's high-level policies and procedures to prevent and detect fraud including the Group's channel for "whistleblowing", as well as whether they have knowledge of any actual, suspected or alleged fraud
- Reading Board minutes
- Considering remuneration incentive schemes and performance targets for management and directors
- Using analytical procedures to identify any unusual or unexpected relationships

We communicated identified fraud risks throughout the audit team and remained alert to any indications of fraud throughout the audit. This included communication from the Group auditor to component auditors of relevant fraud risks identified at the Group level and requesting component auditors performing procedures at the component level to report to the Group auditor any identified fraud risk factors or identified or suspected instances of fraud.

As required by auditing standards, we perform procedures to address the risk of management override of controls and the risk of fraudulent revenue recognition, in particular the risk that management may be in a position to make inappropriate accounting entries.

We did not identify any additional fraud risks.

We performed procedures including:

- Identifying journal entries and other adjustments to test at the Group level and for selected components based on risk criteria and comparing the identified entries to supporting documentation. These included those posted to unusual accounts, including unusual journal pairings in respect of entries recorded to revenue and cash.
- Assessing whether the judgements made in making accounting estimates are indicative of a potential bias.

Identifying and responding to risks of material misstatement related to compliance with laws and regulations

We identified areas of laws and regulations that could reasonably be expected to have a material effect on the financial statements from our general commercial and sector experience and through discussion with the directors and other management (as required by auditing standards), and discussed with the directors and other management the policies and procedures regarding compliance with laws and regulations.

We communicated identified laws and regulations throughout our team and remained alert to any indications of non-compliance throughout the audit.

The potential effect of these laws and regulations on the financial statements varies considerably.

Independent auditor's report to the members of Actium Topco (UK) Limited (continued)

Firstly, the Group is subject to laws and regulations that directly affect the financial statements including financial reporting legislation (including related companies legislation), distributable profits legislation and taxation legislation and we assessed the extent of compliance with these laws and regulations as part of our procedures on the related financial statement items

Secondly, the Group is subject to many other laws and regulations where the consequences of non-compliance could have a material effect on amounts or disclosures in the financial statements, for instance through the imposition of fines or litigation. We identified the following areas as those most likely to have such an effect: anti-bribery, employment law, regulatory capital and liquidity, and certain aspects of company legislation recognising the nature of the Group's activities. Auditing standards limit the required audit procedures to identify non-compliance with these laws and regulations to enquiry of the directors and other management and inspection of regulatory and legal correspondence, if any. Therefore if a breach of operational regulations is not disclosed to us or evident from relevant correspondence, an audit will not detect that breach.

Context of the ability of the audit to detect fraud or breaches of law or regulation

Owing to the inherent limitations of an audit, there is an unavoidable risk that we may not have detected some material misstatements in the financial statements, even though we have properly planned and performed our audit in accordance with auditing standards. For example, the further removed non-compliance with laws and regulations is from the events and transactions reflected in the financial statements, the less likely the inherently limited procedures required by auditing standards would identify it.

In addition, as with any audit, there remained a higher risk of non-detection of fraud, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal controls. Our audit procedures are designed to detect material misstatement. We are not responsible for preventing non-compliance or fraud and cannot be expected to detect non-compliance with all laws and regulations.

Strategic report and directors' report

The directors are responsible for the strategic report and the directors' report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover those reports and we do not express an audit opinion thereon.

Our responsibility is to read the strategic report and the directors' report and, in doing so, consider whether, based on our financial statements audit work, the information therein is materially misstated or inconsistent with the financial statements or our audit knowledge. Based solely on that work:

- we have not identified material misstatements in [the strategic report and] the directors' report,
- in our opinion the information given in those reports for the financial year is consistent with the financial statements, and
- in our opinion those reports have been prepared in accordance with the Companies Act 2006
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit

Independent auditor's report to the members of Actium Topco (UK) Limited (continued)

Matters on which we are required to report by exception

Under the Companies Act 2006, we are required to report to you if, in our opinion

- adequate accounting records have not been kept by the parent Company, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us, or
- the parent Company financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns, or
- certain disclosures of directors' remuneration specified by law are not made, or

We have nothing to report in these respects

Directors' responsibilities

As explained more fully in their statement set out on page 18, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, such internal control as they determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, assessing the Group and parent Company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern, and using the going concern basis of accounting unless they either intend to liquidate the Group or the parent Company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so

Auditor's responsibilities

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue our opinion in an auditor's report. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but does not guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of the financial statements.

A fuller description of our responsibilities is provided on the FRC's website at www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities

The purpose of our audit work and to whom we owe our responsibilities

This report is made solely to the Company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the Company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an auditor's report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the Company and the Company's members, as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.

Adam Craig (Senior Statutory Auditor)
for and on behalf of KPMG LLP, Statutory Auditor
Chartered Accountants
EastWest
Tollhouse Hill
Nottingham
NG1 5FS
1 July 2025

Consolidated statement of comprehensive income
for the period ended 31 March 2025

	Note	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Revenue	2	172,830
Rechargeable expenses		(2,132)
Net fee income		170,698
Cost of sales		(117,851)
Gross profit		52,847
Administration expenses		(63,129)
Operating loss	3	(10,282)
Finance income		129
Finance expense	6	(33,310)
Loss before tax		(43,463)
Taxation	8	1,685
Loss for the period		(41,778)
Items that may be reclassified to profit or loss		
Foreign exchange differences on translation of foreign operations		(1,415)
Total other comprehensive loss for the period		(1,415)
Total comprehensive loss for the period		(43,193)

Consolidated balance sheet
as at 31 March 2025

	Note	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Non-current assets		
Goodwill	11	413,927
Intangible assets	11	257,062
Property, plant and equipment	12	982
Right-of-use assets	7	2,644
Capitalised contract fulfilment costs		254
Total non-current assets		674,869
Current assets		
Trade and other receivables	13	66,202
Current tax receivables		5,562
Cash and cash equivalents	14	15,921
Total current assets		87,685
Current liabilities		
Trade and other payables	15	(47,879)
Provisions	16	(3,430)
Current tax liabilities		(1,215)
Lease liabilities	7	(1,953)
Short-term borrowings	17	(3,500)
Total current liabilities		(57,977)
Non-current liabilities		
Deferred tax liabilities	9	(56,371)
Lease liabilities	7	(806)
Long-term borrowings	17	(438,524)
Other non-current liabilities	18	(13,057)
Total non-current liabilities		(508,758)
Net assets		195,819
Equity		
Issued share capital	20	2,393
Share premium		236,397
Other reserves		(1,193)
Retained earnings		(41,778)
Total shareholders' equity		195,819

The notes on pages 27-67 form part of these consolidated financial statements. These financial statements were approved by the board of directors and signed on its behalf by

J C Paton
Director
30 June 2025

Consolidated statement of changes in equity
for the period ended 31 March 2025

	Issued share capital £'000	Share premium £'000	Other reserves £'000	Retained earnings £'000	Total shareholders' equity £'000
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–	–	–
Comprehensive income					
Loss for the period	–	–	–	(41,778)	(41,778)
Foreign exchange differences on translation of foreign operations	–	–	(1,415)	–	(1,415)
Transactions with shareholders					
Shares issued	2,393	236,397	–	–	238,790
Share-based payment charge	–	–	222	–	222
As at 31 March 2025	2,393	236,397	(1,193)	(41,778)	195,819

Issued share capital

Issued share capital represents the nominal value of issued and fully paid shares, including both ordinary and priority shares. Details of the Group's issued share capital are provided in note 20.

Share premium

Share premium comprises the excess of consideration received over the nominal value of shares issued, net of directly attributable transaction costs incurred in the issuance of those shares, including both ordinary and priority shares.

Other reserves

Other reserves include cumulative exchange differences arising from the translation of foreign operations and the cumulative fair value of equity-settled share-based payments recognised in accordance with IFRS 2.

Retained earnings

Retained earnings represent the cumulative net loss, as recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income, net of dividends and other distributions.

Consolidated cash flow statement
for the period ended 31 March 2025

	Note	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Cash flows from operating activities:		
Loss for the period		(41,778)
Taxation	8	(1,685)
Finance income		(129)
Finance expense	6	33,310
Depreciation charge	3	2,109
Amortisation charge	11	18,625
Share-based payment charge	21	222
Decrease in provisions	16	(317)
Increase in trade and other receivables		(7,472)
Decrease in trade and other payables		(11,600)
Cash used in operations		(8,715)
Tax paid		(4,634)
Net cash used in operating activities		(13,349)
Cash flows from investing activities:		
Interest received		129
Acquisition consideration payments, net of cash acquired	10	(604,793)
Purchase of property, plant and equipment		(424)
Net cash used in investing activities		(605,088)
Cash flows from financing activities:		
Proceeds from issue of shares	20	224,568
Proceeds from long-term borrowings (net of loan arrangement fees)		422,361
Drawdown of short-term borrowings		8,500
Repayment of short-term borrowings		(7,000)
Interest paid		(12,088)
Repayment of lease liabilities	7	(1,586)
Interest paid on lease liabilities	7	(225)
Net cash from financing activities		634,530
Net increase in cash and cash equivalents		16,093
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the period		–
Effect of exchange rate movements on cash		(172)
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the period		15,921

Notes to the consolidated financial statements

1 General information and accounting policies

General information

Actium Topco (UK) Limited is a private company, limited by shares, incorporated in England and Wales with the registered number 15735478. Its registered office is 60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB, United Kingdom. The nature of the Group's operations and its principal activities are set out in the strategic report.

Basis of preparation

The financial statements have been prepared on a going concern basis and in accordance with UK-adopted international accounting standards.

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost basis, except for certain financial instruments that are measured at fair value. The principal accounting policies applied are set out below.

The presentational currency of the financial statements is pound sterling, and all amounts presented have been rounded to the nearest £1,000, except where otherwise stated.

The Company was incorporated on 22 May 2024, and these are its first financial statements prepared to 31 March 2025. The Group did not trade prior to 19 August 2024, which is the date it acquired Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc (refer to note 10 for further details). As such, the results presented reflect the Group's activities for the period from 19 August 2024 to 31 March 2025. No comparative period is presented as the Company was incorporated in the current accounting period.

Basis of consolidation

These financial statements consolidate the Group's financial position of the Company and its subsidiary undertakings as at 31 March 2025.

The financial results of subsidiaries are fully consolidated from the date of acquisition, being the date on which the Group obtains control, and continue to be consolidated until the date that such control ceases. The financial statements of subsidiaries are prepared for the same reporting period as the parent company, using consistent accounting policies.

All intercompany balances, transactions and unrealised gains and losses arising from intercompany transactions are eliminated in full to ensure the consolidated financial statements reflect the Group as a single economic entity.

Going concern

In assessing the Group's and the Company's abilities to continue on a going concern basis for a period of at least 12 months from the approval of these financial statements (the "going concern period"), the directors considered the Group's projected cash flows, cash liquidity and existing borrowing facilities.

As at 31 March 2025, the Group held considerable financial resources including cash balances of £15.9m. The Group also has access, throughout the going concern period, to a revolving credit facility ("RCF") of £50.0m, providing further liquidity, of which £3.5m was drawn at the balance sheet date. See note 17 for details of the Group's banking facilities and note 22 for details of the financial risks facing the Group.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1. General information and accounting policies (continued)

The Group has prepared cash flow forecasts covering the going concern period. The base case forecast assumes trading performance over the going concern period in line with the Board-approved budget. This reflects strong organic revenue growth in FY 26 at broadly consistent margins, and includes deferred and contingent acquisition consideration and expenses, and interest payments due on the Group's financing facilities. The Group has also reflected the effects of the post balance sheet date acquisition of Auxo Solutions LLC, as further disclosed in note 26, the settlement of the initial consideration paid and included the latest RCF and cash balances of the enlarged Group. In this base case, the Group generates sufficient liquidity such that the Group's cash balance remains in excess of the drawn RCF balance through all months of the going concern period. There is therefore no reliance upon this facility in the base case, with the Group able to repay the balance at any time.

The directors considered the principal risks and mitigants (as set out on pages 7-9) and analysed a range of cash flow downside scenarios including a "reverse-stress test" scenario. This models the decline in revenue that the Group would be able to absorb over the going concern period before utilising all the existing cash reserves and all RCF headroom available to the Group until the breaching of the leverage covenant in place under the Group's senior facilities agreement, while assuming consistent non-operating cash flows. This scenario requires annualised revenue reductions of over 26% compared to the base case, while cost mitigants assumed include only realignment of external contractor spend to the revised revenue level and a recruitment freeze, without further, more active management of cash outflows. In this scenario, the Group draws the RCF to a maximum level of £24.3m before a covenant breach is noted and liquidity is eroded. The directors consider this scenario and the sequence of events that could lead to it to be remote.

While the market environment remains competitive, the Group continues to navigate appropriately the rebalancing and improving consulting market conditions, and the directors believe the Group is well positioned to effectively pursue opportunities that support its long-term strategic goals and look forward with confidence for future growth. After careful consideration, the directors have a reasonable expectation that the existing resources of the Group and the Company are adequate to meet the Group's requirements over the going concern period. On this basis, the directors consider that it is appropriate to adopt the going concern basis in preparing the financial statements.

Significant judgements and estimates

The preparation of financial statements in accordance with IFRS requires management to make judgements, estimates and assumptions that affect the application of accounting policies and reported amounts of assets, liabilities, income and expenses. The following section sets out the Group's significant accounting judgements and major sources of estimation uncertainty.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Judgements

In the process of applying the Group's accounting policies, the directors have made one judgement (excluding those involving estimations), which is considered to have a significant effect on the financial statements

Revenue recognition

Revenue is the Group's most significant caption in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income. Whilst the majority of the Group's revenue is contracted on a time and materials basis, the Group also has some fixed-price milestone contracts. The recognition of revenue on such contracts involves consideration of the detailed contractual terms against the requirements of IFRS 15. The key judgements include assessment of whether revenue should be recognised over time or at a point in time, and whether the performance obligations under the contract have been met at the balance sheet date, to best reflect the transfer of services through the life of each contract. Further information regarding the methods used to recognise revenue for both time and materials and milestone contracts is provided in the Group's accounting policy, as detailed on pages 36-37. Revenue disclosures are provided in note 2.

Estimates

Several estimates have been made in the preparation of the financial statements. These estimates are based on assumptions derived from historical experience and other factors, including expectations of future events that are considered reasonable under the circumstances. The assumptions form the basis for determining the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities where these are not readily apparent from other sources. Estimates and underlying assumptions are reviewed on an ongoing basis. Revisions to accounting estimates are recognised in the period in which the estimate is revised, and in any future periods affected. Actual results may differ from these estimates.

The directors have identified four significant areas of estimation that have a material effect on the financial statements. These are described below.

Goodwill impairment review

The goodwill impairment review is a major source of estimation uncertainty. Determining the value-in-use of the relevant groups of cash-generating units ("CGUs") involves significant judgement and estimation. These calculations require management to make assumptions regarding future cash flows, discount rates and long-term growth rates. Although no impairment of goodwill was recognised in the period, a change in these assumptions could lead to a different outcome. Sensitivity disclosures relating to the Group's goodwill impairment review are provided in note 11.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1. General information and accounting policies (continued)

Valuation of intangible assets arising from business acquisitions

The directors have identified the valuation of intangible assets arising from business acquisitions as a significant area involving estimation. However, this is not considered a major source of estimation uncertainty as defined by IAS 1 as there is no significant risk of a material adjustment to the carrying amount within the next financial year. Intangible assets are initially recognised at fair value at the acquisition date, and subsequent remeasurement at fair value is not typically required unless there is an indicator of impairment. Although it is not considered a major source of estimation uncertainty, this estimate is highlighted due to its material effect on the financial statements in the period. Further details of the intangible assets acquired in the period are provided in note 11.

Useful lives of intangible assets

The determination of useful lives for intangible assets is a major source of estimation uncertainty, given the high carrying value of such assets in the Group's balance sheet. Management assesses the estimated useful lives on an asset-by-asset basis, considering factors such as expected usage, technical or commercial obsolescence, and contractual terms. Details of the useful lives applied are disclosed in the accounting policy for intangible assets on page 32. If the useful lives of all intangible assets (excluding order backlog) were reduced by one year, the amortisation expense for the period would have increased by approximately £1.4m.

Contingent acquisition consideration liabilities

The estimation of contingent acquisition consideration liabilities is a major source of estimation uncertainty, as the contingent consideration payable in each case is linked to the future performance of the acquiree. To determine the fair value of contingent acquisition consideration liabilities, the directors assess the expected future performance of the acquired businesses against earn-out targets, and discount the expected earn-out payments back to present value using an appropriate risk-adjusted discount rate. These estimates could change over time based on a change in the actual or expected performance of the acquired businesses over the earn-out period. Refer to note 10 for disclosures on contingent acquisition consideration liabilities.

Principal accounting policies

The principal accounting policies adopted in the preparation of these consolidated financial statements are set out below.

Property, plant and equipment

All property, plant and equipment are stated at historical cost (or deemed historical cost) less accumulated depreciation. Cost includes the original purchase price of the asset and the costs directly attributable to bringing the asset to its working condition for its intended use.

Depreciation is applied on all property, plant and equipment at rates calculated to write each asset down to its estimated residual value on a straight-line basis over the following useful lives:

Property, plant and equipment class	Useful life
Fixtures and fittings	3 years
Computer equipment	3 years

Useful lives and estimated residual values are reviewed annually and adjusted as appropriate.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Business acquisitions

Business acquisitions are accounted for as at the acquisition date, which is the date on which control of the business is transferred to the Group. Assets acquired and liabilities assumed in a business acquisition are measured at their fair values at the acquisition date, including any identifiable intangible assets. Goodwill arises when the fair value of the consideration for a business exceeds the fair value of the identifiable net assets acquired. Goodwill and intangible assets arising on the acquisition of a foreign operation are held in local currency and are retranslated into the Group's presentational currency, pound sterling, at each reporting date using the closing foreign exchange rate.

Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration

Deferred and contingent consideration may arise on acquisitions. Deferred consideration arises when settlement of part of the consideration relating to the acquisition falls due after the acquisition date. Contingent consideration arises where consideration is dependent on specified future events or conditions, typically linked to the financial performance of the business acquired.

Deferred and contingent consideration is discounted to present value and recognised as capital investment cost at fair value when the consideration is not employment-linked. Alternatively, where amounts payable are dependent upon future employment, these amounts are recognised as a remuneration expense over the deferral or contingent performance period.

In circumstances where there is an option to settle in the form of cash or a variable number of shares, the Group recognises a financial liability for the fair value of the discounted consideration. Where consideration is settled in a fixed number of shares, the consideration is classified as equity, it is not remeasured, and settlement is accounted for within equity.

Subsequent to the acquisition date, amounts relating to deferred consideration are measured at amortised cost. Contingent consideration liabilities are recognised at fair value through profit or loss.

At each balance sheet date, the fair value of contingent consideration is measured using level 3 inputs in accordance with the fair value hierarchy. These calculations contain estimation uncertainty, as they relate to unknown future cash flows. The key inputs associated with the valuation of these liabilities include the value and timing of expected future earn-out payments (based on the expected financial performance of the relevant businesses), and an appropriate risk-adjusted discount rate to apply to these future cash flows.

Changes in the carrying amount of deferred and contingent consideration liabilities associated with the passage of time are recognised as a finance cost. Other changes to the fair value of the liabilities resulting from changes in the underlying assumptions are recognised in administration costs.

Consideration payments, including all deferred and contingent consideration payments, are reported within investing activities in the consolidated statement of cash flows, except for employment-linked payments, which are reported within operating activities.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Intangible assets

Intangible assets acquired in a business acquisition are identified and recognised separately from goodwill where they meet the definition of an intangible asset under IAS 38. Such assets are only recognised if

- They are capable of being separated or divided from the Group and sold, transferred, licensed, rented or exchanged, either individually or with a related contract or asset, or
- They arise from contractual or other legal rights, regardless of whether those rights are transferrable or separable from the entity or from other rights and obligations

The cost of intangible assets acquired in a business combination is measured at their fair value as at the acquisition date. To determine this fair value, management estimates the timing and amount of future cash flows attributable to the assets, which are then discounted to present value using a suitable post-tax discount rate. These cash flow projections are based on forecasts available at the acquisition date and are extrapolated over an appropriate period using reasonable growth assumptions. The discount rate reflects current market assessments of the time value of money and the specific risks associated with the asset and the acquired business.

All intangible assets acquired through business acquisitions are amortised over their estimated useful lives. Useful lives are re-assessed at each reporting date.

The classes of intangible assets recognised by the Group, their useful lives and the methods used to determine the fair value of the intangible assets are set out below.

Intangible asset class	Useful life	Valuation method
Customer relationships	9-14 years	Excess earnings method
Brand names	3-20 years	Relief from royalty method
Intellectual property	4-7 years	Relief from royalty / excess earnings method
Order backlog	1 year	Excess earnings method

Impairment of non-financial assets

Goodwill is tested for impairment annually. For impairment testing, goodwill is allocated to each of the Group's cash-generating units ("CGUs") or groups of cash-generating units expected to benefit from the synergies of the related acquisition. The CGUs have been grouped in line with the Group's divisions as this is the level at which goodwill is monitored by management.

The Group performs impairment reviews at the reporting period end to identify any goodwill that has a carrying value that is in excess of its recoverable amount. Determining the recoverability of goodwill requires judgement in both the methodology applied and the key assumptions within that methodology. If it is determined that an impairment is required, the carrying amount of the goodwill is reduced to its recoverable amount with the difference recorded as an impairment charge in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income. Any impairment loss recognised for goodwill is not reversed.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

For other non-financial assets (excluding deferred tax assets), the Group assesses whether there is any indication that these assets may be impaired. If any such indication exists, then the asset's recoverable amount is estimated. The recoverable amount of an asset is the greater of its value in use or its fair value, less costs to sell. In assessing value in use, the estimated future cash flows are discounted to their present value using a pre-tax discount rate that reflects current market assessments of the time value of money and the risks specific to the asset.

For the purposes of impairment testing, assets that cannot be tested individually are grouped together into the smallest group of assets that generates independent cash inflows (the CGU), that is, cash inflows from continuing use that are largely independent of the cash inflows of other assets or groups of assets.

An impairment loss is recognised if the carrying amount of an asset or its CGU exceeds its estimated recoverable amount. Impairment losses are recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income. Impairment losses recognised in respect of CGUs are allocated first to reduce the carrying amount of any goodwill allocated to the units and then to reduce the carrying amounts of other assets in the CGU (or group of CGUs) on a pro-rata basis.

An impairment loss relating to non-financial assets, excluding goodwill, is reversed if, and only if, the reasons for the impairment have ceased to apply. Impairment losses relating to goodwill are never reversed.

Foreign exchange

Transactions in foreign currencies are translated to the relevant entity's functional currency at the average foreign exchange rate in the month of the transaction. Monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies at the balance sheet date are retranslated to the functional currency of the relevant entity at the foreign exchange rate ruling at that date. Non-monetary assets and liabilities that are measured in terms of historical cost in a foreign currency are translated using the exchange rate at the date of the transaction and are not retranslated. Foreign exchange gains and losses arising on the retranslation of monetary assets and liabilities into functional currency are recognised in administration expenses, or in finance expenses where they relate to borrowings.

The revenue and expenses of foreign operations are translated to the Group's presentational currency, pound sterling, at the average foreign exchange rate in the month of the date of the transactions. The assets and liabilities of foreign operations, including goodwill and intangible assets, are translated to the Group's presentational currency at foreign exchange rates ruling at the balance sheet date. Foreign exchange gains and losses arising on retranslation of assets and liabilities to the Group's presentational currency are recognised in other comprehensive income. These gains and losses may be reclassified subsequently to profit or loss if certain conditions are met.

Financial instruments

The Group has financial instruments including cash and cash equivalents, trade and other receivables, trade and other payables, borrowings, and priority shares. The main purpose of these financial instruments is to fund the Group's business strategy and working capital requirements. Accounting policies for each type of financial instrument are set out on page 34.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents comprise cash held in bank accounts. Such balances are measured at amortised cost in accordance with IFRS 9.

Trade and other receivables

Trade and other receivables are recognised initially at fair value, equal to the transaction price, and are subsequently measured at amortised cost less provision for expected credit losses. The trade receivables balances recorded in the Group's consolidated balance sheet are held until realised in cash.

The Group provides services to customers on credit terms with mainly arrears billing, resulting in an element of credit risk. The Group applies the IFRS 9 simplified approach to measure an expected credit loss provision for trade receivables, which involves using a lifetime expected loss allowance. The calculation of expected credit losses begins with grouping trade receivables based on shared credit characteristics, being days past due. Historical loss rates for each ageing category serve as the initial basis for estimating credit losses. These rates are adjusted for macroeconomic conditions, customer-specific factors, and relevant forward-looking information to ensure a comprehensive assessment of potential credit risk. These adjusted rates are applied to the aged trade receivables balance at the reporting date to calculate the expected credit loss provision.

Trade and other payables

Trade and other payables are initially recognised at fair value, equal to the transaction price, and are subsequently measured at amortised cost. Trade and other payables due within one year are not discounted.

Borrowings

Borrowings are initially recognised at fair value, net of directly attributable transaction costs. Given all the Group's borrowings are on market terms, their initial fair value is equal to the amount of proceeds received. Subsequent to initial recognition, borrowings are measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method. Interest expense, including the amortisation of any fees or costs, is recognised in profit or loss over the term of the borrowing using the effective interest rate. Borrowings are derecognised when the related obligation is repaid or extinguished.

Priority shares

The Group's capital structure includes ordinary shares and priority shares. The priority shares are classified as equity, as the Group has an unconditional right to avoid the obligation to deliver cash to the holders. The priority shares do not carry redemption rights, and the associated "priority amount", which accrues on a daily basis and compounds annually at a rate of 12%, is distributable at the discretion of the Group.

Upon the occurrence of certain events (such as a listing, sale, or return of capital), the priority shares rank ahead of ordinary shares in receiving proceeds, including any accrued priority amount. This does not give rise to a financial liability under IAS 32 *Financial Instruments: Presentation*, as the relevant provisions in the Articles of Association govern the allocation of proceeds by a third-party buyer, rather than imposing an obligation on the Group.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1. General information and accounting policies (continued)

Proceeds received from the issue of priority shares are recognised in equity. The accrued priority amount is not recognised as an expense in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income. Any distributions, if made, are recorded as deductions from equity.

Where priority shares are held by an employee and that employee leaves the Group, the priority amount on those shares may be adjusted downwards if the individual is not classified as a "good leaver". In addition, the Group may elect to repurchase the shares, including the settlement of any accrued priority amount. Where such an election is made, the obligation gives rise to a financial liability, and the associated priority amount is recognised as a finance expense in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income. The priority amount payable to the employee is not treated as a distribution because it arises not from the individual's status as a shareholder, but from the substance of the arrangement, effectively compensating the individual for a financing arrangement during their period of service.

Provisions

Provisions are distinct from other liabilities as there is uncertainty over the timing or amount of the cash outflow required to settle the liability. Provisions are measured at the present value of the expenditure expected to be required to settle the obligation. The Group applies a "most likely outcome" approach in valuing these obligations, as this is most appropriate for the type of provisions which the Group holds. These are discounted to present value using an appropriate pre-tax discount rate, where the time value of money is material.

Taxation

Current tax is the amount of income tax payable in respect of the taxable profit for the year, using tax rates enacted or substantively enacted at the balance sheet date, and any adjustment to tax payable in respect of previous years. Current tax is recognised in profit or loss except to the extent that it relates to items recognised in other comprehensive income or directly in equity, in which case the related tax is recognised in the same place.

Deferred tax is recognised in respect of temporary differences between the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities in the financial statements and the corresponding tax bases used in the computation of taxable profit. Deferred tax liabilities are generally recognised for all taxable temporary differences, and deferred tax assets are recognised to the extent that it is probable that future taxable profits will be available against which deductible temporary differences can be utilised. Deferred tax is measured using the tax rates and laws that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the balance sheet date and are expected to apply when the related deferred tax asset is realised or the deferred tax liability is settled.

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are offset only when there is a legally enforceable right to offset current tax assets against current tax liabilities, and there is an intention to settle on a net basis.

Leases

The Group leases office premises on various terms, typically between one to five years. Each lease is assessed individually and may include options to extend or break early. Contracts can include both lease and non-lease components, but only the lease components are accounted for under IFRS 16.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Upon commencement of a lease, the Group recognises a lease liability at the present value of future lease payments, discounted using the interest rate implicit in the lease or, if not available, the Group's incremental borrowing rate. The incremental borrowing rate reflects the cost the Group would incur to borrow funds for a similar asset. Lease liabilities include payments beyond the non-cancellable period where it is reasonably certain the Group will exercise an extension option or not exercise an early break clause. Lease payments are split between finance expenses and a reduction in the lease liability, with finance costs recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income over the lease term.

Right-of-use assets are initially measured as equal to the lease liability, adjusted for lease incentives and initial direct costs. Right-of-use assets are subsequently depreciated on a straight-line basis over the shorter of the asset's useful life or the lease term.

The Group utilises the exemption available in IFRS 16 for short-term leases (less than 12 months in duration) and low-value leases (for assets worth less than \$5,000 when new). No lease liability or right-of-use asset is recognised for these leases, with lease expenses instead being recognised in administration costs on a straight-line basis over the lease term.

Revenue recognition

Revenue consists of the value of work executed for clients during the period and expenses recharged, exclusive of VAT. Revenue is classified into net fee income and rechargeable expenses. Net fee income represents the Group's personnel, subcontractor and related expertise and services sold to clients. Recharged expenses represent the recharge of costs incidental to fulfilling contracts including flights, subsistence and accommodation on which nil or negligible margin is earned by the Group.

The Group delivers services that have no alternative use to Alpha (advice to clients, reports, etc.) as the services are specifically tailored to clients' projects and scope of work. The majority of the Group's revenue is contracted on a time and materials basis, where the performance obligation is to provide consultancy resources at agreed day rates. For such contracts, revenue is recognised over time, as consultant days worked are delivered. Modifications or extensions to such projects are recognised as services are delivered. Contract extensions, where the scope or price of the contract increases, are treated as separate contracts. Contracts accounted for on a time and materials basis are billed incrementally, typically monthly, for incurred time and materials.

Revenue recognition for fixed-fee milestone projects is based on the satisfaction of performance obligations in line with contractual project milestones, depending on the nature of the performance obligations for the project. For most fixed-fee milestone projects, revenue is recognised at a point in time upon delivery of each performance obligation and these projects are typically billed as contractual milestones are delivered and the right to payment exists. Contractual milestones are only treated as separate performance obligations by the Group when they are distinct from the other elements in the contract and could provide a benefit to the customer without further work being completed. In some circumstances, revenue from fixed fee milestone projects is recognised over time where the Group has an enforceable right to payment for performance completed to date, before the contractual milestone has been fully delivered. Material scope changes to fixed-fee milestone projects are managed via a new agreement with the client.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

For the Group's Aiviq business, revenue relating to right-to-access software licensing fees is recognised over time, as the benefits of the software are consumed by the customer over the licence period. Associated implementation and other services are recognised in line with the underlying performance obligation, either over the contractual licence period where the associated service is not distinct from the licence, or in line with the work performed where the service provided is deemed distinct from the underlying licence. This assessment is made at a contractual level based on the level of interdependency between the promises in each related contract.

Revenue is wholly attributable to the principal activities of the Group. For all revenue types, payment is typically due between 30 and 60 days after the invoice date or receipt of invoice, depending on the client and region.

Contract receivables

Revenue recognised for performance obligations satisfied but not yet invoiced is recorded as a contract receivable within accrued income, up to the value of the applicable project milestone. Once invoiced, the balance is reclassified to trade receivables.

Contract liabilities

Where amounts invoiced in respect of a contract exceed the revenue recognised for performance obligations satisfied to date, the excess is recorded as a contract liability within deferred income. This is released to revenue in future periods as the performance obligations are satisfied.

Cost of sales

Cost of sales is defined by management as the direct costs associated with the generation of the Group's revenue, including staff payroll and contractor costs that are directly attributable to the delivery of services and supporting growth.

Rechargeable expenses, including travel and subsistence costs directly recharged to clients, are presented separately in the Group's statement of comprehensive income.

Capitalised contract fulfilment costs

Costs directly attributable to the fulfilment of unsatisfied or partially unsatisfied performance obligations are recognised as an asset when they generate or enhance resources of the Group and are expected to be recovered. These costs principally relate to partially completed milestones on fixed-fee contracts, and to non-distinct software implementation activities incurred in advance of the client's licence period on Aiviq contracts. These capitalised costs are recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income at the point of revenue recognition for fixed-fee milestone projects or are amortised over the licence period for non-distinct implementation activities.

Administration expenses

Administration expenses are defined by management as costs incurred by the Group that are not directly associated with the generation of revenue. This includes items such as head office staff costs, recruitment and professional fees and IT services, which are expensed as incurred. Administration expenses exclude finance income and expenses and taxation, which are presented separately in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Defined contribution pension costs

The Group operates defined contribution pension schemes in which the Group pays fixed contributions into a separate fund and has no legal or constructive obligation to pay further amounts. The cost of contributions to these schemes is recognised as an expense in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income in the period in which the employees perform the related work. A liability is recognised in the consolidated balance sheet for any contributions due but not yet paid at the reporting date.

Share-based payments

The Group operates a management incentive plan ("MIP"), available to certain members of senior management, comprising an allocation of "C" and "D" classes of ordinary shares, which are subscribed for by the participant at a subscription price generally below the accounting fair value. These shares are intended to be held until a future exit event (a sale of the Company or similar), with the Group holding a reacquisition right to repurchase the shares for a variable cash consideration amount where relevant employees leave prior to such an exit event.

As such, the Group has accounted for the MIP as a share-based payment arrangement under IFRS 2 *Share-based Payment*, in which the Group has a choice of settlement and there is not considered to be a present obligation to settle in cash. Therefore, subscriptions for shares under these schemes are initially treated as equity-settled share-based payments.

The total expense to be apportioned over the MIP vesting period is determined by reference to the fair value at the date of subscription, less the subscription price paid by the employee. Fair value is determined using a Monte Carlo simulation model, which incorporates various internal and external factors, including share price volatility, risk-free interest rates, and the expected timing of an exit event. This model simulates a range of possible outcomes to estimate the fair value of the MIP shares at grant date.

The share-based payment expense in each period is recognised as an expense in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income, with a corresponding adjustment to equity. At each reporting date, the assumptions in relation to the number of MIP shares expected to be held at exit are adjusted for the effects of non-market-based vesting conditions, primarily relating to personal performance and continued employment, to reflect the Group's best estimate at that date. The impact of any revisions to the original estimates is recognised by adjusting the cumulative expense recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income.

Under the rules of the MIP, if the Group exercises its right to reacquire shares upon an employee's departure, it does not expect to repurchase such shares for an amount exceeding their fair value at the date of reacquisition. Accordingly, any repurchase of MIP shares is accounted for as an equity transaction and is recognised as a deduction from equity.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Other employee benefits

The Group operates a profit share scheme and other short-term bonus arrangements, which pay a percentage of an employee's salary, subject to Group or divisional financial performance in the related year. These bonuses are accrued at each reporting date based on management's best estimate of the amounts expected to be paid, reflecting current year performance. The associated expense is recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income as an employee benefit cost. The bonus accrual is not considered a significant source of estimation uncertainty due to the short time frame and high certainty of payment at the reporting date.

Other short-term employee benefits, including salaries, holiday pay and medical cover, are accrued as the related services are rendered.

New accounting standards and interpretations

As the Company was incorporated at the start of the current period and this is the Group's first set of financial statements, the accounting policies set out above were adopted for the first time in the period. As such, there were no changes in accounting policies in the period.

The following standards, interpretations and amendments have been issued but were not mandatory for the current accounting period and have therefore not yet been adopted by the Group:

- Lack of Exchangeability (Amendments to IAS 21), effective from 1 January 2025
- Amendments to IFRS 9 and IFRS 7 – Amendments to the Classification and Measurement of Financial Instruments, effective from 1 January 2026
- Annual Improvements to IFRS Accounting Standards – Volume 11, effective from 1 January 2026
- Contracts Referencing Nature-dependent Electricity (Amendments to IFRS 9 and IFRS 7), effective from 1 January 2026 (not yet endorsed by the UK)
- IFRS 18 *Presentation and Disclosures in Financial Statements*, effective from 1 January 2027 (not yet endorsed by the UK)
- IFRS 19 *Subsidiaries without Public Accountability Disclosures*, effective from 1 January 2027 (not yet endorsed by the UK)

None of these new standards, interpretations or amendments are expected to have a material impact on the Group.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Audit exemptions for UK subsidiaries

Certain of the Company's UK subsidiaries have taken advantage of the parent company guarantee exemption to prepare unaudited accounts in accordance with Section 479A of the Companies Act 2006. The name and registered number of each subsidiary company taking advantage of the audit exemption are shown below.

Subsidiary company	Registered number
Actium Bidco (UK) Limited	15736419
Actium Midco 1 (UK) Limited	15735608
Actium Midco 2 (UK) Limited	15735686
Actium Midco 3 (UK) Limited	15736277
Aiviq Limited	11480862
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Group Limited	07160664
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting MENA Limited	14638009
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting UK Limited	04710715
Alpha FMC Bidco Limited	09928343
Axxsys Limited	04967647
Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited	11524091
Bankside Payroll Limited	12406540
Lionpoint Group (UK) Limited	09869494
Obsidian Solutions Ltd	09737564
White Marble Consulting Limited	09027730

A full list of the Company's subsidiary undertakings is disclosed in note 2 of the Company's financial statements on page 72.

2 Revenue

Revenue by division

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Asset & Wealth Management	109,438
Alternatives	45,885
Insurance	8,832
Strategy & Deals	3,532
Agency	2,267
Aiviq	2,876
Total revenue	172,830

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

2. Revenue (continued)

Revenue by geography

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
UK	75,322
North America	63,471
Europe	24,607
Rest of the world	9,430
Total revenue	172,830

Remaining performance obligations

Remaining performance obligations represent the revenue that the Group will earn from certain contracts with customers in future when the Group satisfies performance obligations that are unsatisfied or partially unsatisfied at the reporting date. These mainly relate to Aiviq's multi-year software licence contracts with a remaining contractual period of between one and five years, for which software revenue is recognised over time across the access period.

The table below sets out the total transaction price allocated to remaining performance obligations at the reporting date. In line with the practical expedient in IFRS 15, the disclosure excludes performance obligations relating to contracts with an expected original duration of less than one year and contracts where revenue is recognised on a time and expenses basis.

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
To be recognised within one year	4,139
To be recognised between one and three years	6,105
To be undertaken and recognised after three years	2,743
Total remaining performance obligations	12,987

The movement in contract liabilities in the period is set out in note 15.

3 Operating loss

Operating loss for the period is stated after charging the following expenses:

	Note	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Amortisation of intangible assets	11	18,625
Depreciation charge	7,12	2,109
Foreign exchange losses		664
Short-term lease expense	7	629
Movement in expected credit loss provision on trade receivables		87
Staff costs	4	108,561
Transaction costs on business acquisitions		16,518

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

3. Operating loss (continued)

The auditor's remuneration for the period is as follows

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Audit fees	493
Other non-audit services	–
Total fees payable to the auditor	493

4. Staff costs

The table below shows the average number of Group employees, excluding contractors, for the period following the acquisition of Alpha on 19 August 2024. The Group did not have any employees prior to this date.

	Period ended 31 March 2025 Number
Consulting employees	1,077
Administration employees	120
Average number of employees	1,197

Total staff costs included in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income were as follows

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Wages, salaries and short-term benefits	94,975
Social security costs	9,171
Defined contribution pension costs	4,193
Share-based payment charge	222
Total staff costs	108,561

5 Directors' remuneration

The aggregate remuneration of the directors of the Company in the period, as defined by Schedule 5 of *The Large and Medium-sized Companies and Groups (Accounts and Reports) Regulations 2008*, was as follows

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Wages, salaries and short-term benefits	516
Defined contribution pension contributions	29
Aggregate remuneration paid to directors	545

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

5 Directors' remuneration (continued)

The highest paid director received total remuneration of £340,000 in the period, of which £27,000 related to defined contribution pension contributions

No directors exercised share options or received any amounts under long-term incentive schemes in relation to qualifying services provided to the Company in the period

One director was accruing benefits under a defined contribution pension scheme

A fee of £70,000 is payable to Bridgepoint Advisers Limited for making available the services of certain directors of the Company in the period. This fee is not included in the amounts disclosed in the table on page 42

6 Finance expense

	Note	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Interest on facility B term loans and revolving credit facility		13,922
Amortisation of loan arrangement fees		446
Foreign exchange loss on borrowings		2,253
Interest on investor loan notes		14,795
Unwind of discounting on deferred and contingent acquisition consideration	10	1,669
Interest expense on lease liabilities	7	225
Total finance expense		33,310

Interest on the facility B term loans and the revolving credit facility is settled in cash on a regular basis, typically every one to six months

Interest on investor loan notes may either be settled in cash or allowed to compound annually, at the sole discretion of the Group. The Group currently does not intend to cash settle this interest in the near term, and the accrued interest is expected to be rolled up into the loan balance

Further details on the Group's borrowings are provided in note 17

7 Leases

Right-of-use assets

	Offices £'000
Net book value	
As at 22 May 2024	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	4,177
Additions	188
Depreciation charge	(1,693)
Foreign exchange movements	(28)
As at 31 March 2025	2,644

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

7 Leases (continued)

Lease liabilities

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Due within one year	2,123
Due between one year and five years	867
Due after five years	–
Total lease liabilities – undiscounted	2,990
Effect of discounting	(231)
Total lease liabilities – discounted	2,759
Represented by	
Current	1,953
Non-current	806
Total lease liabilities – discounted	2,759

Amounts recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Depreciation of right-of-use assets	1,693
Short-term lease expense	629
Variable service charges	47
Included in administration expenses	2,369
Interest expense on lease liabilities	225
Included in finance expenses	225

Total lease payments made in the period amounted to £2 4m, of which £1 8m related to lease liabilities and £0 6m related to short-term leases

The Group has no material income or expenses associated with sub-leasing arrangements, sale-and-leaseback transactions, or variable lease payments

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

8. Taxation

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Current tax	
Current tax on profits/losses for the period	1,919
Deferred tax	
Origination and reversal of temporary differences	(3,604)
Total taxation credit for the period	(1,685)

The difference between the total tax expense shown above and the amount calculated by applying the standard UK corporate tax rate to the Group's loss before tax is explained as follows

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Loss before tax	(43,463)
Tax at the standard UK corporation tax rate of 25%	(10,866)
Effects of:	
Expenses not deductible for taxation	5,182
Non-deductible interest	3,977
Effect of tax rates in foreign jurisdictions and changes in tax rates	(90)
Withholding and other local taxes	112
Total taxation credit for the period	(1,685)

The effective tax rate of 3% is lower than the standard UK corporation tax rate of 25%, primarily due to the non-deductibility of acquisition-related transaction costs and restrictions on interest deductibility under applicable tax legislation

9. Deferred tax

	As at 22 May 2024	Business acquisitions £'000	Recognised in income £'000	Exchange differences £'000	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Intangible assets	–	(70,065)	4,706	256	(65,103)
Property, plant and equipment	–	(138)	4	–	(134)
Interest restriction	–	–	762	–	762
Tax losses carried forward	–	8,481	(2,094)	(1)	6,386
Other temporary differences	–	1,494	226	(2)	1,718
Net deferred tax liabilities	–	(60,228)	3,604	253	(56,371)

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are offset in the consolidated balance sheet only when there is a legally enforceable right to offset current tax assets against current tax liabilities and an intention to settle on a net basis. In all jurisdictions where the Group operates, sufficient deferred tax liabilities exist to offset the deferred tax assets, and accordingly, all deferred tax assets have been offset against the related deferred tax liabilities. As a result, no deferred tax assets are presented separately in the consolidated balance sheet.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

10 Business acquisitions

During the period, the Group acquired Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc ("Alpha"), White Marble Group Limited ("White Marble") and Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited ("Bankside")

Assets and liabilities acquired

	Alpha £'000	White Marble £'000	Bankside £'000	Total £'000
Intangible assets – customer relationships	223,957	1,257	6,502	231,716
Intangible assets – brand names	33,338	–	–	33,338
Intangible assets – intellectual property	2,361	23	620	3,004
Intangible assets – order backlog	8,472	58	178	8,708
Property, plant and equipment	953	26	–	979
Right-of-use assets	4,008	169	–	4,177
Trade and other receivables	57,186	505	1,677	59,368
Cash and cash equivalents	22,953	42	250	23,245
Trade and other payables	(62,042)	(616)	(1,862)	(64,520)
Provisions	(3,759)	–	–	(3,759)
Current tax receivables / (liabilities)	1,745	(54)	(50)	1,641
Lease liabilities	(4,008)	(169)	–	(4,177)
Borrowings	(2,000)	–	–	(2,000)
Deferred tax liabilities	(58,082)	(334)	(1,812)	(60,228)
Net identifiable assets acquired	225,082	907	5,503	231,492
Consideration	625,895	3,470	17,831	647,196
Goodwill on acquisition	400,813	2,563	12,328	415,704

Composition of acquisition consideration

	Alpha £'000	White Marble £'000	Bankside £'000	Total £'000
Cash paid on completion	611,673	1,374	6,283	619,330
Non-cash consideration settled on completion	14,222	–	–	14,222
Contingent cash consideration	–	2,096	11,548	13,644
Total consideration	625,895	3,470	17,831	647,196

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

10. Business acquisitions (continued)

Acquisition of Alpha

On 19 August 2024, the Group acquired 100% of the issued share capital of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc ("Alpha"). The Group views Alpha as a leading independent specialist operating in the large and growing financial services consulting market, importantly with a distinct culture and a high calibre team of professionals. The sector is expected to benefit from long-term growth drivers, including digital transformation, increasing financial services regulation, evolving product complexity, cost pressures and continued growth in assets under management.

Goodwill of £400.8m arising from the acquisition primarily reflects the value of the acquired workforce, the profitability of the business, its established experience in the specialist financial services consulting sector, and anticipated future growth opportunities. None of the goodwill is expected to be deductible for tax purposes.

The total consideration for the acquisition amounted to £625.9m and was fully settled on completion. Of this amount, £611.7m was paid in cash, and £14.2m was satisfied through a share-for-share exchange, whereby certain members of Alpha's senior management received shares in Actium Topco (UK) Limited in exchange for their shareholdings in Alpha. There is no deferred or contingent consideration associated with the acquisition.

The gross amount of trade and other receivables acquired was £57.8m. An expected credit loss provision of £0.6m was recognised on acquisition, representing the Group's best estimate of contractual cash flows not expected to be collected. The fair value of the acquired receivables is estimated as £57.2m, which is equal to the gross amount less the expected credit loss provision.

Acquisition of White Marble

On 2 September 2024, the Group acquired 100% of the issued share capital of White Marble Group Limited ("White Marble"), a specialist marketing consultancy firm to asset management, wealth management and alternatives clients. This acquisition extends the Group's specialist sector-focussed offering, and the combined expertise of White Marble and the Group creates a holistic range of client solutions from brand strategy to supporting go-to-market projects, to end-to-end digital and creative services support. The acquisition will enable the Group to build a leading marketing, brand and creative agency proposition to financial services clients globally. White Marble was re-branded to Alpha Agency after the acquisition date.

Goodwill of £2.6m arising from the acquisition primarily reflects the expected synergies from integrating White Marble into the Group, as well as the value of the acquired workforce and anticipated future growth opportunities. None of the goodwill is expected to be deductible for tax purposes.

The acquired trade and other receivables are recognised at fair value, which is equal to their gross amount of £0.5m as no material credit losses are expected.

The maximum potential cash consideration payable by the Group under the acquisition agreement is £6.1m, comprising £1.4m of initial cash consideration paid on completion and up to £4.7m in contingent earn-out payments. The earn-out is linked to White Marble's financial performance against specified profit targets over a three-year earn-out period, and may be settled in up to three instalments, with the final payment due in June 2028.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

10 Business acquisitions (continued)

The total consideration recognised at the acquisition date was £3.5m, consisting of £1.4m of cash paid on completion and £2.1m representing the fair value of contingent consideration. The fair value of the contingent consideration was determined by discounting the expected future payments, which are based on management's expectations of how the acquired business will perform against the earn-out targets, using a risk-adjusted discount rate of 22.5%.

The directors estimate that the undiscounted amount of contingent consideration that may become payable could reasonably range between £nil and £4.7m.

Acquisition of Bankside

On 4 September 2024, the Group acquired 100% of the issued share capital of Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited ("Bankside"), a UK based technology consulting firm providing specialist data integration services to the asset and wealth management sector. The combination of the Group's leading consulting capability for the asset and wealth management sector and the Bankside team's deep expertise and toolsets will enhance the Group's competitive end-to-end offering for clients through large-scale and complex technical implementations.

Goodwill of £12.3m arising from the acquisition primarily reflects the expected synergies from integrating Bankside into the Group, the value of the acquired workforce, the profitability of the business and anticipated future growth opportunities. None of the goodwill is expected to be deductible for tax purposes.

The acquired trade and other receivables are recognised at fair value, which is equal to their gross amount of £1.7m as no material credit losses are expected.

The maximum potential cash consideration payable by the Group under the acquisition agreement is £25.1m, comprising £6.3m of initial cash consideration paid on completion and up to £18.8m in contingent earn-out payments. The earn-out is linked to Bankside's financial performance against specified profit targets over a three-year earn-out period and may be settled in multiple instalments across four years, with the final payment due in August 2028.

The total consideration recognised at the acquisition date was £17.8m, consisting of £6.3m of cash paid on completion and £11.5m representing the fair value of contingent consideration. The fair value of the contingent consideration was determined by discounting the expected future payments, which are based on management's expectations of how the acquired business will perform against the earn-out targets, using a risk-adjusted discount rate of 21.0%.

The directors estimate that the undiscounted amount of contingent consideration that may become payable could reasonably range between £14.3m and £18.8m.

Contribution of acquired businesses to revenue and profit

In aggregate, the Alpha, White Marble and Bankside acquisitions contributed all of the Group's revenue and a profit after tax of £5.2m in the period. The newly established holding companies contributed a loss after tax of £47.0m in the period, resulting in a total Group loss after tax of £41.8m. If the acquisitions had all been completed at the start of the reporting period on 22 May 2024, the Group's revenue for the period would have been £238.1m and its loss after tax would have been £55.6m, excluding any adjustments relating to the amortisation of intangible assets.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

10. Business acquisitions (continued)

Movements in deferred and contingent consideration

	Bankside £'000	White Marble £'000	Shoreline £'000	Lionpoint £'000	Total £'000
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–	–	–
Additions	11,548	2,096	1,177	10,033	24,854
Employment-linked charge	–	–	41	46	87
Payments in the period	–	–	–	(10,123)	(10,123)
Unwind of discounting	1,345	264	60	–	1,669
Fair value adjustment	–	(51)	(553)	–	(604)
Foreign exchange movements	–	–	(62)	46	(16)
As at 31 March 2025	12,893	2,309	663	2	15,867
Represented by					
Non-current	10,356	2,309	–	2	12,667
Current	2,537	–	663	–	3,200
As at 31 March 2025	12,893	2,309	663	2	15,867

Additions to deferred and contingent consideration in the period include amounts relating to Lionpoint Holdings, Inc ("Lionpoint"), and Shoreline Consulting Pty Ltd and Shoreline Consolidated Pty Ltd and its subsidiaries (together, "Shoreline"). These amounts relate to acquisitions previously made by Alpha and were already recognised as liabilities in Alpha's balance sheet at the date of its acquisition by the Group. They have now been recognised in the Group's consolidated balance sheet as part of the acquisition accounting for Alpha. An element of the acquisition consideration associated with Lionpoint and Shoreline is employment-linked, which means the amounts are accrued over time as a remuneration expense. There is no significant estimation uncertainty associated with the deferred and contingent consideration liabilities recognised in relation to Lionpoint and Shoreline as at 31 March 2025.

Total payments of £10.1m were made during the period in respect of deferred and contingent consideration. Of this, £1.4m related to employment-linked consideration and is presented within net cash generated from operating activities in the consolidated cash flow statement. The remaining £8.7m, which is not employment-linked, is presented within net cash used in investing activities.

The unwind of discounting of £1.7m is recognised within finance expenses in the period, and the fair value adjustment of £0.6m is recognised as a credit within administration expenses.

As at 31 March 2025, the total deferred and contingent consideration liability was £15.9m, comprising £0.7m of deferred consideration and £15.2m of contingent consideration.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

11. Goodwill and intangible assets

Goodwill

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Cost	
As at 22 May 2024	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	415,704
Foreign exchange movements	(1,777)
As at 31 March 2025	413,927

Goodwill represents the excess of the cost of an acquisition over the fair value of the Group's share of the net identifiable assets of the acquired subsidiary at the date of acquisition. Goodwill arising on the acquisition of a foreign operation is recorded in the functional currency of that foreign operation and is retranslated into the Group's presentational currency at each reporting date using the closing foreign exchange rate.

The goodwill recognised in the period is attributable to the acquisitions of the Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc, White Marble Group Limited and Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited. Refer to note 10 for further details.

Allocation of goodwill to cash-generating units

Goodwill has been allocated to the Group's divisions, as shown in the table below. These divisions represent groups of cash-generating units ("CGUs"), consistent with how the Group manages and monitors its operations. For simplicity, these groups of CGUs are referred to as CGUs throughout this note.

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Asset & Wealth Management	228,779
Alternatives	135,038
Insurance	33,356
Strategy & Deals	11,656
Agency	2,563
Aviq	2,535
As at 31 March 2025	413,927

Impairment review

The carrying amount of goodwill is not subject to systematic amortisation but is instead reviewed annually for impairment. The review assesses each CGU to which goodwill has been allocated by comparing the carrying amount of the CGU, including goodwill, with the recoverable amount of the CGU. Deferred tax liabilities arising on acquired intangible assets are included within the carrying amount of each CGU for the purposes of the impairment review. Including these deferred tax liabilities within the CGU's carrying amount ensures consistency with the goodwill arising on acquisition under IFRS 3 *Business Combinations*, and avoids a notional impairment in the first year after the acquisition that does not reflect any deterioration in the recoverable amount of the CGUs.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

11. Goodwill and intangible assets (continued)

The recoverable amount of each CGU has been assessed by reference to value in use, which is estimated using cash flows from forecasts prepared by management around the balance sheet date. The key assumptions considered to be individually significant for the purposes of calculating the value in use of each CGU include future growth rates, profit margins and the pre-tax discount rates used to convert the estimated cash flows to present value.

The board-approved budget for the year ended 31 March 2026 forms the basis for the cash flow projections for each CGU. The cash flow projections for the following four years reflect the directors' expectations of the medium-term operating performance of the CGU and the growth prospects in the relevant market. The factors considered in relation to each CGU include the size of the CGU, the maturity of its operations, its market share and the Group's strategic pillars. Thereafter, a long-term growth rate is applied to the terminal period, reflecting the long-term outlook for each CGU.

To determine the recoverable amount of each CGU, future cash flows have been discounted to their present value using CGU-specific pre-tax discount rates. These rates reflect current market assessments of the time value of money and the risks specific to each CGU, including the geographic regions in which the CGU operates and the nature, maturity, and stability of its operations.

The cash flow projections are stated on a nominal basis, incorporating expected inflationary effects over the forecast period to ensure consistency with the nominal discount rates applied. The Group has also considered costs in relation to climate change when forecasting future cash flows.

Sensitivity analysis

Given the level of goodwill recognised in the consolidated balance sheet following the acquisition of Alpha, the impairment review is sensitive to reasonably possible changes in the key assumptions underlying the recoverable amount of each CGU. The key assumptions are as follows:

- **Medium-term growth rate** the rate at which earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation ("EBITDA") is expected to grow in years two to five of the forecast period
- **Long-term growth rate** the rate at which EBITDA is assumed to grow in perpetuity, used to determine the terminal value
- **Pre-tax discount rate** the rate used to discount forecast cash flows to present value, reflecting a market participant's view of the weighted average cost of capital

The following table presents, for each CGU, the impairment headroom (being the amount by which recoverable amount exceeds carrying amount), the values assigned to each of the key assumptions, and, where reasonably possible, the change in each assumption that would reduce headroom to nil.

CGU	Impairment headroom £'000	Key assumptions			Reasonably possible change in assumptions required to reduce headroom to nil		
		Medium-term growth rate	Long-term growth rate	Pre-tax discount rate	Medium-term growth rate	Long-term growth rate	Pre-tax discount rate
Asset & Wealth Management	16,138	8.7%	1.6%	14.8%	(160) bps	(90) bps	60 bps
Alternatives	6,125	16.6%	1.7%	14.8%	(110) bps	(50) bps	40 bps
Insurance	4,646	40.7%	1.5%	15.0%	(490) bps	(210) bps	150 bps
Strategy & Deals	3,484	15.2%	1.5%	15.3%	(880) bps	n/a	360 bps
Agency	3,500	24.4%	1.5%	27.3%	n/a	n/a	n/a
Arviq	3,003	30.1%	1.5%	14.7%	(270) bps	n/a	350 bps

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

11 Goodwill and intangible assets (continued)

Intangible assets

	Customer relationships £'000	Brand names £'000	Intellectual property £'000	Order backlog £'000	Total £'000
Cost					
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–	–	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	231,716	33,338	3,004	8,708	276,766
Foreign exchange movements	(993)	(149)	(3)	(40)	(1,185)
As at 31 March 2025	230,723	33,189	3,001	8,668	275,581
Amortisation					
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–	–	–
Charge for the period	(11,607)	(1,336)	(342)	(5,340)	(18,625)
Foreign exchange movements	66	9	–	31	106
As at 31 March 2025	(11,541)	(1,327)	(342)	(5,309)	(18,519)
Net book value as at 31 March 2025	219,182	31,862	2,659	3,359	257,062

Customer relationships

Customer relationships represent the value attributed to the Group's established and stable customer base acquired through business acquisitions

The fair value of customer relationships is determined at the acquisition date using the excess earnings method. This approach calculates the present value of the earnings attributable to the customer relationships, after deducting a reasonable return on other contributory assets. Key assumptions used in the valuation include forecast revenue growth from existing customers, expected profit margins, the customer attrition rate and an appropriate discount rate.

Given the significant value attributed to customer relationship intangible assets, the calculation of their fair value is sensitive to key assumptions. A one percentage point increase in the discount rate would reduce the recognised fair value of customer relationships arising from business acquisitions by approximately £13.8m. Similarly, a one percentage point increase in the assumed annual customer attrition rate would result in a reduction of approximately £15.5m.

Customer relationships are amortised over their estimated useful lives, which range from 9 to 14 years, reflecting the period over which the customer relationships are expected to materially contribute to the Group's earnings.

Brand names

Brand names represent the value attributed to the Alpha, Aiviq and Lionpoint brand names acquired through business acquisitions.

The fair value of brand names is determined at the acquisition date using the relief-from-royalty method. This approach estimates the present value of the notional royalty payments the Group would be willing to make to license the brand names if they were not owned. Key assumptions in the valuation include the selected royalty rate, forecast revenue attributable to each brand name, and an appropriate discount rate.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

11 Goodwill and intangible assets (continued)

Brand names are amortised over their estimated useful lives, which range from 3 to 20 years. The amortisation period reflects the strength of each brand and the expected duration over which they will generate economic benefits for the Group.

The Lionpoint brand was rebranded to Alpha Alternatives shortly after the acquisition. As a result, the Lionpoint brand name has been recognised as a defensive intangible asset with a short useful life of 3 years.

Intellectual property

Intellectual property represents the value of proprietary technology and software assets acquired through business acquisitions, including the Aiviq software platform.

The fair value of intellectual property intangible assets is determined at the acquisition date using an income approach – either the excess earnings method or the relief-from-royalty method – depending on the nature of the technology. Further details on the application of these methodologies and the key assumptions used are provided in the “customer relationships” and “brand names” sections above.

Intellectual property intangible assets are amortised over their estimated useful lives, which range from 4 to 7 years, reflecting the anticipated rate of technological obsolescence and the timeframe over which the assets are expected to generate economic benefits for the Group.

Order backlog

The order backlog represents the value attributed to committed contracts with customers that have been acquired through business acquisitions.

The fair value of the order backlog is determined at the acquisition date using the excess earnings method. This approach calculates the present value of the earnings attributable to the order backlog, after deducting a reasonable return on other contributory assets. Key inputs used in the valuation include contracted revenue, expected profit margins, and an appropriate discount rate.

The order backlog is amortised over its useful life of up to one year, reflecting the expected period over which the contracts will be fulfilled.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

12. Property, plant and equipment

	Fixtures & fittings £'000	Computer equipment £'000	Total £'000
Cost			
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	100	879	979
Additions	13	415	428
Foreign exchange movements	(1)	(17)	(18)
As at 31 March 2025	112	1,277	1,389
Depreciation			
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–
Charge for the period	(18)	(398)	(416)
Foreign exchange movements	(3)	12	9
As at 31 March 2025	(21)	(386)	(407)
Net book value as at 31 March 2025	91	891	982

13 Trade and other receivables

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Trade receivables	47,613
Less allowance for expected credit losses	(693)
Trade receivables – net	46,920
Accrued income	12,799
Other receivables	2,832
Prepayments	2,984
Capitalised contract fulfilment costs	667
Total trade and other receivables – current	66,202

Trade receivables are non-interest bearing and generally have a 30 to 60-day term. Due to their short maturities, the carrying amount of trade and other receivables is a reasonable approximation of their fair value.

The Group recognises expected credit losses on trade receivables using a provision matrix, which is based on historical credit loss experience adjusted for forward-looking factors. Historical loss rates are determined separately for each ageing category through a detailed analysis of historical credit losses by territory. Forward-looking factors include both macroeconomic conditions and specific risk indicators relevant to the Group's customers.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

13. Trade and other receivables (continued)

	Expected loss rate %	Gross carrying amount £'000	Expected credit loss provision £'000	Net carrying amount £'000
Not overdue	0.9%	31,973	(291)	31,682
Overdue 1-30 days	1.5%	11,436	(168)	11,268
Overdue 31-60 days	2.2%	1,635	(36)	1,599
Overdue 61-90 days	4.8%	609	(29)	580
Overdue 90+ days	8.6%	1,960	(169)	1,791
Expected credit losses as at 31 March 2025		47,613	(693)	46,920

Capitalised contract fulfilment costs comprise amounts incurred in relation to unsatisfied performance obligations on fixed-fee milestone projects, and software implementation costs incurred in advance of the commencement of the client's licence period on Aiviq contracts. As at 31 March 2025, total capitalised contract fulfilment costs were £0.9m, of which £0.2m was presented within non-current assets on the face of the consolidated balance sheet. These costs are recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income at the point of revenue recognition for fixed-fee milestone projects or are amortised to the consolidated statement of comprehensive income over the licence period for software implementation costs. In the period, an expense of £0.5m was recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income in relation to capitalised contract fulfilment costs. No significant judgements have been made in determining the amount of costs to be capitalised, which primarily comprise costs within scope of IAS 19 Employee Benefits.

Accrued income relates to satisfied performance obligations where revenue has been recognised but not invoiced at the reporting date. Accrued income is recognised on a time spent basis as performance obligations are met based on agreed fees and day rates, billed in arrears. These are typically short-term timing differences that are administrative in nature at each reporting date. All accrued income balances are expected to be realised within one year and are classified within current assets.

The expected credit loss provision in relation to accrued income was not material as at 31 March 2025. For analysis of the Group's exposure to credit risk, refer to note 22.

14. Cash and cash equivalents

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Cash at bank	15,921
Cash and cash equivalents	15,921

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

15 Trade and other payables

	Note	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Trade payables		2,940
Accruals		25,539
Deferred income		4,999
Taxation and social security		7,185
Other payables		2,182
Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration	10	3,200
Accrued interest on facility B term loans	17	1,834
Total trade and other payables – current		47,879

Trade payables comprise amounts outstanding for trade purchases and ongoing costs. The carrying amount of trade and other payables is a reasonable approximation of their fair value. The Group's trade payables payment policy is to make payment within the agreed terms, which is generally 30 days from the date of receipt of invoice.

Accruals include amounts in respect of employee bonuses and other payroll-related liabilities, as well as costs relating to contractors and other suppliers that had not been invoiced at the period end.

The deferred and contingent acquisition consideration liability comprises the amounts due within one year relating to the Shoreline and Bankside acquisitions. Refer to note 10 for further details.

Deferred income represents contract liabilities arising from the Group's revenue-generating activities, where consideration is received in advance of the satisfaction of performance obligations under contracts with customers. These liabilities typically result from short-term timing differences between the delivery of performance obligations under fixed-fee milestone or software licence contracts and the related billing schedules. The table below shows the movement in deferred income during the period and includes both current and non-current balances. There were no material movements in deferred income arising from contract modifications or changes in estimates.

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Deferred income at the start of the period	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	3,637
Recognised in revenue in the period	(3,328)
Revenue deferred in the period	5,073
Foreign exchange movements	7
Deferred income at the end of the period	5,389

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

16. Provisions

	Social security tax provisions £'000	Legal and other provisions £'000	Total £'000
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–
Business acquisitions (note 10)	3,418	341	3,759
Utilised	–	(34)	(34)
Released	(118)	(165)	(283)
Additions	–	–	–
Foreign exchange movements	(12)	–	(12)
As at 31 March 2025	3,288	142	3,430

Included within social security tax provisions is £2.2m in respect of potential historical tax exposures originating before the time of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc's AIM admission, and a further £1.1m relating to more recent potential social security tax exposures. The amount and timing of these social security and sales tax provisions are subject to uncertainty. A final position agreed with a tax authority or through the expiry of a tax audit period could differ from the estimated provision.

Legal and other provisions comprise £0.1m of dilapidation provisions relating to the Group's leased offices.

Given the uncertainty, a range of outcomes is possible in relation to these provisions. The directors consider the cash outflows in relation to all provisions could reasonably range between £nil and £6.3m.

17. Borrowings

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Short-term borrowings	
Revolving credit facility	3,500
Total short-term borrowings	3,500
Long-term borrowings	
Facility B term loans – principal	230,924
Loan arrangement fees	(7,195)
Investor loan notes – principal	200,000
Investor loan notes – accrued interest	14,795
Total long-term borrowings	438,524

In August 2024, the Group entered into a senior facilities agreement with a syndicate of lenders to borrow £230.0m through facility B term loans. The proceeds (net of fees) were used to fund the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

17 Borrowings (continued)

Following drawdown, £88.0m of the loans was redenominated into US dollars (\$115.7m) and £44.0m into euros (€52.2m). The foreign currency-denominated portions are retranslated into pound sterling at each balance sheet date. The loans bear variable interest linked to the benchmark rates applicable to each currency. Facility B term loan accrued interest is presented within trade and other payables (note 15) and is cash-settled on a regular basis. The term loans are repayable in August 2031.

Loan arrangement fees of £7.6m were incurred at the inception of the facilities agreement. These fees were deducted from the loan proceeds received and presented net against loans in the consolidated balance sheet. The fees are amortised to interest expense over the term of the loan using the effective interest method.

Under the same facilities agreement, the Group has access to a £50.0m revolving credit facility (RCF), which is available to support general corporate purposes, including working capital requirements. The RCF can be drawn and repaid flexibly until its maturity in February 2031 and accrues interest at a variable rate linked to SONIA. As at 31 March 2025, £3.5m had been drawn on the facility. The Group also has access to a £50.0m acquisition and capital expenditure facility, which remained undrawn as at 31 March 2025.

Certain Group subsidiaries act as guarantors of the debt under the senior facilities agreement, and the lenders hold security, subject to customary exclusions and limitations, over the shares and certain material assets (including bank accounts and intercompany receivables) of specific Group subsidiaries. From 30 June 2025, the Group will be subject to a debt covenant relating to net leverage.

Separately, in August 2024, the Group also entered into an agreement with Bridgepoint Europe VII Nominees Limited to borrow £200.0m in the form of investor loan notes. These loan notes accrue interest at a fixed rate of 12% per annum, compounded annually. The Group has sole discretion to either settle the accrued interest in cash or allow it to continue compounding. As at 31 March 2025, £14.8m of interest had accrued. As the Group does not intend to cash-settle the accrued interest within 12 months, it is presented within long-term borrowings. The investor loan notes are repayable in March 2034.

Disclosures relating to interest rate risk and foreign exchange risk are provided in note 22.

18 Other non-current liabilities

	Note	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Deferred and contingent consideration	10	12,667
Deferred income		390
Total other non-current liabilities		13,057

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

19. Changes in liabilities arising from financing activities

	Note	22 May 2024 £'000	Business acquisitions £'000	Cash flows £'000	Interest accrued £'000	Foreign exchange movements £'000	Other changes £'000	31 March 2025 £'000
Short-term borrowings	17	–	2,000	1,500	–	–	–	3,500
Long-term borrowings	17	–	–	422,361	14,795	922	446	438,524
Accrued interest	15	–	–	(12,088)	13,922	–	–	1,834
Lease liabilities	7	–	4,177	(1,810)	225	(21)	188	2,759
Totals		–	6,177	409,963	28,942	901	634	446,617

20 Share capital

	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Issued and fully paid	
A ordinary shares – 4,126,985 shares of £0.01 each	41
B ordinary shares – 255,578 shares of £0.01 each	3
C1 ordinary shares – 534,371 shares of £0.01 each	5
D1 ordinary shares – 534,371 shares of £0.01 each	5
Priority shares – 233,878,671 shares of £0.01 each	2,339
Total issued share capital	2,393

Shares were issued for total consideration of £238.8m, comprising cash proceeds of £224.6m and non-cash consideration of £14.2m. The non-cash consideration relates to the acquisition of Alpha, under which certain members of Alpha's senior management exchanged their shareholdings in Alpha for shares in Actium Topco (UK) Limited. Refer to note 10 for further details on the acquisition of Alpha.

The rights of each class of share, as set out in the Company's articles of association, are summarised below.

A ordinary shares

A ordinary shares have full voting rights, rights to dividends to the extent declared on the relevant class of shares, and no rights of redemption. On a return of capital, these shares rank behind priority shares and alongside B ordinary shares and C1 ordinary shares.

B ordinary shares

B ordinary shares have full voting rights, rights to dividends to the extent declared on the relevant class of shares, and no rights of redemption. On a return of capital, these shares rank behind priority shares and alongside A ordinary shares and C1 ordinary shares. These shares are also subject to "drag along" and "tag along" provisions.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

20 Share capital (continued)

C1 ordinary shares

C1 ordinary shares have no voting rights or rights of redemption. These shares do have a right to dividends to the extent declared on the relevant class of shares. On a return of capital, these shares rank behind priority shares and alongside A ordinary shares and B ordinary shares. These shares are also subject to leaver, "drag along" and "tag along" provisions. Further details on this class of share are provided in note 21.

D1 ordinary shares

D1 ordinary shares have no voting rights, no rights to dividends and no rights of redemption. On a return of capital, a "ratchet" mechanism is applied, whereby these shares hold no value unless an investor hurdle is achieved. These shares are also subject to leaver, "drag along" and "tag along" provisions. Further details on this class of share are provided in note 21.

Priority shares

Priority shares have no voting rights and no rights of redemption. They accrue a "priority amount" daily, which compounds annually at a rate of 12.0%. This amount is distributable at the discretion of the board (with investor consent). On a return of capital, priority shares – including with the accrued priority amount – rank ahead of all other classes of shares. They rank *pari passu* with the investor loan notes (see note 17). Where held by employees, priority shares are also subject to leaver, "drag along" and "tag along" provisions. The priority shares are classified as equity, as the Group has an unconditional right to avoid the obligation to deliver cash to the holders. Further details on the accounting policy for priority shares are included in note 1.

21 Share-based payments

Management incentive plan

During the period, in January 2025, the Group implemented a new management incentive plan ("MIP") to retain and incentivise certain members of senior management following the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc.

This MIP consists of the allocation of "C" and "D" classes of ordinary shares in the Company. "C1" and "D1" shares are subscribed for across most territories, while participants in France acquire "C2" and "D2" MIP shares through an *Attributions Gratuites d'Actions* ("AGA") plan, following a staggered vesting period and subject to continuing employment. All MIP share allocations and issuances are subscribed for by participants at a subscription price generally below the accounting fair value and are intended to deliver value to the holders on the occurrence of an exit event, provided the value of the Group on exit is above a certain threshold. The "C" class shares rank *pari passu* with all other ordinary shares upon exit. The "D" class shares represent a "ratchet" mechanism, whereby these shares hold no economic value to the holder on exit unless an investor hurdle in the exit value is achieved, at which point the holder would be entitled to an additional share of any proceeds.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

21. Share-based payments (continued)

In the period, 614,675 "C" class shares and 614,675 "D" class shares were issued or allocated to employees, with a remaining amount reserved for new joiners, promotions, or any future share incentive scheme. Shares subscribed for under this plan are either held directly by the participant or on behalf of the employee by an employee benefit trust ("EBT").

These MIP shares are subject to certain vesting conditions concerning personal performance and ongoing employment through the period until exit. Where these conditions are not met, the Group has the right to repurchase these MIP shares from the employee for a variable level of cash consideration. Where the Group repurchases a MIP share, it can then be transferred to or subscribed for by a new participant. No repurchases have been made in the period.

Movements in the period

During the period ended 31 March 2025, a total of 1,229,350 MIP shares were granted to senior management, as summarised in the table below.

	C1 shares issued	D1 shares issued	C2 shares allocated	D2 shares allocated	Total
Outstanding at the beginning of the period	–	–	–	–	–
Issued during the period	534,371	534,371	–	–	1,068,742
Allocated during the period	–	–	80,304	80,304	160,608
Outstanding at the end of the period	534,371	534,371	80,304	80,304	1,229,350

As noted previously, the initial subscription price for the shares is variable, ranging from nil or nominal cost to subscription at an assessed market value of the shares at grant.

The weighted average remaining contractual life of these shares is assumed to be 4.4 years, which is based on management's best estimate of an exit date at the reporting date.

During the period, an initial allocation of MIP shares occurred in January 2025, with a smaller allocation in February 2025 for new joiners. The fair value of all MIP shares was determined at the grant date with the assistance of a third-party valuations expert using a Monte Carlo simulation model. This model estimates fair value by simulating a range of possible outcomes based on randomised inputs for uncertain variables, such as share price volatility. It also incorporates the waterfall mechanism inherent in the Group's capital structure to determine how value would be distributed among shareholders under different scenarios.

The key inputs to the Monte Carlo model were as follows:

Input	Value
Total equity value (at grant date)	£401.8m
Exercise price	nil
Volatility	40.0%
Expected life	4.6 years
Risk-free rate	4.2%

For Monte Carlo valuation purposes only, the total equity value at grant date is calculated before the deduction of investor loan notes (note 17) and priority shares (note 20).

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

21. Share-based payments (continued)

Volatility is the rate at which the price of a security moves up and down. It is estimated by calculating the annualised standard deviation of daily changes in share price of a basket of comparable companies with similar characteristics, adjusted for leverage.

The weighted average fair value per share has been calculated as £12.42 for the "C" class MIP shares and £1.25 for the "D" class MIP shares.

The share-based payment expense has been adjusted to reflect management's best estimate of the number of MIP shares expected to be held at exit, incorporating the effect of non-market-based vesting conditions, primarily relating to personal employee performance and continued employment.

The Group recognised a total share-based payment expense of £0.2m in the period, entirely in relation to the equity-settled share-based payment accounting for these MIP shares.

Settlement of obligations relating to Alpha's previous share options

As part of the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc, as detailed in Note 10, the Group assumed a liability for employer's social security arising from the settlement of previous share incentive schemes operated by Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc. All outstanding share options were exercised in full prior to the completion of the acquisition, resulting in a Group liability of £4.2m, which was fully settled with the relevant local tax authorities during the period.

22. Financial instruments

Carrying amount of financial assets and liabilities

	Total £'000
Financial assets measured at amortised cost	
Cash and cash equivalents	15,921
Trade and other receivables (i)	62,551
Total financial assets measured at amortised cost	78,472
Financial liabilities measured at amortised cost	
Trade and other payables (ii)	32,495
Lease liabilities	2,759
Borrowings (net of loan arrangement fees) (iii)	442,024
Total financial liabilities measured at amortised cost	477,278
Financial liabilities measured at fair value	
Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration	15,867
Total financial liabilities measured at fair value	15,867

(i) Trade and other receivables (note 13) as presented in the table above exclude capitalised contract fulfilment costs and prepayments as these are non-financial assets.

(ii) Trade and other payables (note 15) in the table above exclude deferred income and taxation and other social security as these are non-financial liabilities. Earn-out and deferred consideration liabilities are presented as a separate line item in the table above.

(iii) Borrowings (note 17) are shown net of loan arrangement fees in the table above.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

22 Financial instruments (continued)

The Group's financial instruments as disclosed in the table above arise in the ordinary course of business and their main purpose is to provide finance for the Group's operations and growth. The carrying amount of these financial instruments is deemed to be approximate to fair value. There has been no impairment loss recognised in respect of financial assets, except for the expected credit loss provision as disclosed in note 13.

Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration is measured at fair value in accordance with IFRS 13. The fair value is classified as level 3 in the fair value hierarchy, as the valuation is based on unobservable inputs. A description of the key assumptions and inputs used in the calculation of the fair value of these liabilities is provided in note 10.

The Group's operations expose it to a variety of financial risks including credit risk, liquidity risk, and market risk. The board of directors has overall responsibility for internal control and risk management. The policies set by the board of directors are implemented by the Group's finance team and risk management team.

Credit risk

The Group's credit risk is primarily attributable to potential default on its trade receivables. The Group considers a default to have occurred when a balance is over 90 days overdue and there is no realistic prospect of payment. The Group has policies that require appropriate credit checks on potential customers before sales are made.

The Group has provided for a lifetime expected credit loss against the trade receivables balance at the balance sheet date. The likelihood of default is assessed by reference to the ageing category of the receivables. Refer to note 13 for further details. Were the expected credit loss rates applied to receivables to increase by 1% for each ageing category, the resulting additional credit loss to the Group would be £0.5m.

Liquidity risk

The Group has access to a £50.0m revolving credit facility (RCF) alongside its cash balances, ensuring that it has sufficient available funds for its operations. The Group monitors its levels of working capital to ensure that it can meet its liabilities as they fall due.

The concentration of liquidity risk is primarily around interest payments and deferred and contingent acquisition consideration payments. The Group's cash and RCF are expected to be sufficient to cover these liabilities as they fall due.

The following table details the contractual maturity for the Group's financial liabilities. The amounts disclosed are the undiscounted cash flows, based on the earliest date on which the Group could be required to pay. The table includes all principal and interest cash flows to the maturity date of the Group's financial liabilities. Interest payments are estimated based on the interest rates applicable as at 31 March 2025. Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration payments are based on the Group's current estimate of the amounts that will become payable, based on management's expectations of how the acquired businesses will perform against the relevant earn-out targets.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

22 Financial instruments (continued)

	Note	Due within one year £'000	Due within one year to five years £'000	Due after five years £'000	Total £'000
Trade payables	15	2,940	–	–	2,940
Accruals	15	25,539	–	–	25,539
Other payables	15	2,182	–	–	2,182
Deferred and contingent acquisition consideration	10	3,494	19,937	–	23,431
Interest		17,167	112,542	483,326	613,035
Short-term borrowings	17	3,500	–	–	3,500
Long-term borrowings	17	–	–	430,924	430,924
Total		54,822	132,479	914,250	1,101,551

Long-term borrowings due after five years may become repayable earlier in certain circumstances, such as an exit event (i.e. a sale of the Company or similar). In such cases, the total interest payable would be reduced accordingly.

A separate maturity analysis of the Group's lease liabilities is disclosed in note 7.

Market risk

Market risk is the risk the future cash flows of a financial instrument will fluctuate because of changes in market prices, including interest rates, foreign exchange rates and inflation.

Interest rate risk

The Group has exposure to interest rate risk through its borrowings, which are subject to variable interest rates. These variable interest rates are linked to the SONIA, EURIBOR, and Term SOFR rates, plus an applicable margin. Fluctuations in these rates can have an impact on the Group's borrowing costs.

If the variable interest rate applicable to the Group's borrowings had been 2% higher in the period ended 31 March 2025, the Group's finance expense would have increased by £2.9m. This sensitivity calculation assumes all other variables, in particular foreign currency exchange rates, remain constant.

After the reporting period, the Group entered into derivative financial instruments to manage its exposure to rising interest rates. Refer to note 26 for further details.

Foreign currency exchange rate risk

The Group is exposed to foreign exchange risk due to its geographically diverse operations. Revenue is earned in various foreign currencies across North America, Europe, APAC and the Middle East. The Group also holds assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies within these regions. Consequently, the Group's financial performance and position is subject to exchange rate fluctuations, which may affect reported revenue and result in gains or losses on the translation of foreign currency assets and liabilities.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

22 Financial instruments (continued)

The impact on the Group's revenue in the period arising from a 5.0% adverse movement in all foreign exchange rates relevant to the Group would be £5.1m (3.0%). The same sensitivity would also result in a decrease in the Group's net assets of £14.1m.

The table below shows the Group's cash and cash equivalents, trade receivables and trade payables in the Group's main currencies.

	GBP '000	EUR '000	USD '000	CAD '000	CHF '000	SGD '000	AUD '000	DKK '000	AED '000
Cash and cash equivalents	3,601	3,389	8,693	295	976	664	885	7,572	209
Trade receivables	19,155	4,574	26,114	700	2,490	476	1,035	3,715	2,895
Trade payables	(1,931)	(210)	(931)	(30)	(80)	(3)	(49)	–	(59)
Net amount	20,825	7,753	33,876	965	3,386	1,137	1,871	11,287	3,045

The currency profile of the Group's borrowings is disclosed in note 17.

Inflation risk

Inflation risk is the risk that the increased rate of inflation in the market will have a material impact on the Group's forecasted cash flows. The Group has therefore considered current and plausible inflation levels when forecasting future cash flows. The Group does not believe that inflationary pressures represent a material risk to the Group's financial performance or position.

23 Capital management

The Group manages its capital structure to support its ability to continue as a going concern, provide returns to shareholders, and benefit from the use of capital gearing. The capital structure comprises net debt (calculated as borrowings less cash and cash equivalents) and shareholders' equity. From 30 June 2025, the Group will be subject to, in certain circumstances, a debt covenant relating to net leverage. The directors review the capital structure periodically and may adjust it in response to changes in economic conditions, the Group's business strategy, or investment opportunities. There have been no changes to the Group's approach to capital management during the period. The table below provides a breakdown of the Group's capital.

	Note	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Short-term borrowings	17	3,500
Long-term borrowings	17	438,524
Cash and cash equivalents	14	(15,921)
Net debt		426,103
Shareholders' equity		195,819
Total capital		621,922

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

24. Related party transactions

Bridgepoint

The Group is majority owned by certain funds managed by Bridgepoint Advisers Limited, an indirect subsidiary of Bridgepoint Group plc. As a result of this relationship, Bridgepoint Group plc and its subsidiaries are considered to be related parties of the Group.

Bridgepoint Europe VII Nominees Limited holds investor loan notes issued by the Company with an outstanding principal amount of £200,000,000 as at 31 March 2025. Interest of £14,795,000 was accrued during the period in respect of these investor loan notes. This interest remained unpaid as at 31 March 2025. Further details of the loan notes are disclosed in note 17.

A fee of £70,000 is payable to Bridgepoint Advisers Limited for making available the services of certain directors of the Company in the period. This amount was unpaid as at 31 March 2025 and is included within accruals (note 15).

Key management personnel

Key management personnel are those individuals who have authority and responsibility for planning, directing and controlling the activities of the Group. In the opinion of the directors, the Group's key management personnel comprise the statutory directors of the Company, as listed in the directors' report on page 16. Although two of the directors were formally appointed to the Company's board after the reporting period, in June 2025, they are considered key management personnel from the date they joined the Group in January 2025, based on the roles and responsibilities they assumed from that time.

Staff costs in the period in relation to these key management personnel were as follows:

	Period ended 31 March 2025 £'000
Wages, salaries and short-term benefits	737
Social security costs	132
Defined contribution pension costs	29
Share-based payment charge	23
Total staff costs for key management personnel	921

There were no other transactions with key management personnel or close members of their family.

Subsidiary companies

Transactions and outstanding balances between the Company and its subsidiaries have been eliminated on consolidation and are therefore not disclosed in this note.

Notes to the consolidated financial statements (continued)

25. Ultimate controlling party

Based on the definition of control in IFRS 10 *Consolidated Financial Statements*, the ultimate controlling party of the Group is Actium Topco (UK) Limited, which is the Company preparing these consolidated financial statements

The Group is majority owned by certain funds managed by Bridgepoint Advisers Limited, an indirect subsidiary of Bridgepoint Group plc. There are a range of limited partners who invest in these funds, none of whom have a controlling interest in Actium Topco (UK) Limited.

26 Events after the reporting period

Acquisition of Auxo Solutions LLC

After the reporting period, in June 2025, the Group acquired Auxo Solutions LLC, a leading technology engineering company specialising in modern enterprise solutions, cloud, data and AI for the financial services industry. The acquisition brings specialist technology engineering expertise that further strengthens the Group's offering to the financial services sector and ensures the Group can help its clients more widely solve some of their greatest challenges. It also extends the Group's footprint in North America, supporting the execution of its strategic growth objectives.

The maximum potential cash consideration payable by the Group under the acquisition agreement is \$125.0m. This comprises an initial payment of \$40.0m on completion (subject to working capital and other customary closing adjustments) and up to \$85.0m of contingent consideration. The contingent consideration is linked to the financial performance of the acquired business over a two-year period, with up to \$40.0m payable in July 2026 and up to \$45.0m in July 2027.

In addition, a Management Retention Plan ("MRP") has been established for certain employees of Auxo Solutions LLC. The MRP is conditional on continued employment and the achievement of specified Group growth targets. It provides the participants with economic rights equivalent to those attached to the Company's B ordinary shares and priority shares.

Due to the proximity of the acquisition to the date of approval of these financial statements, the initial accounting for the business acquisition has not yet been completed, and as such, the full disclosures required under IFRS 3 *Business Combinations* have not been provided.

Drawdown of debt facilities

As described in note 17, the Group has access to a £50.0m acquisition and capital expenditure facility, which was undrawn as at 31 March 2025. After the reporting period, in June 2025, the Group drew down \$40.0m (£29.4m) on this facility to finance the initial cash consideration for the acquisition of Auxo Solutions LLC, as described above.

The Group also drew down further amounts on its revolving credit facility to fund transaction costs associated with the acquisition and to support general working capital and currency requirements. As at the date of the approval of these financial statements, £9.6m was outstanding under the revolving credit facility.

Derivative financial instruments

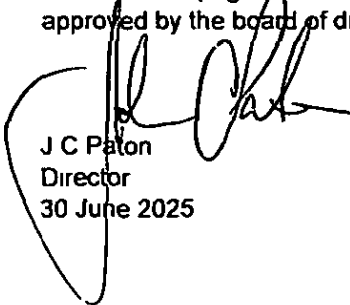
After the reporting period, in June 2025, the Group entered into derivative financial instruments in the form of interest rate zero-cost collars to manage its exposure to rising interest rates. The instruments cover approximately 70% of the value of the Group's facility B term loans.

**Company balance sheet
as at 31 March 2025**

	Note	As at 31 March 2025 £'000
Non-current assets		
Investments	2	238,790
Total non-current assets		238,790
Net assets		238,790
Equity		
Share capital	4	2,393
Share premium		236,397
Other reserves		222
Retained earnings		(222)
Total shareholders' equity		238,790

As permitted by Section 408 of the Companies Act 2006, a separate income statement for the Company has not been presented. The Company's loss for the period was £0.2m.

The notes on pages 70-73 form part of these financial statements. These financial statements were approved by the board of directors and signed on its behalf by


J C Paton
Director
30 June 2025

Company statement of changes in equity
for the period ended 31 March 2025

	Issued share capital £'000	Share premium £'000	Other reserves £'000	Retained earnings £'000	Total shareholders' equity £'000
As at 22 May 2024	–	–	–	–	–
Comprehensive income					
Loss for the period	–	–	–	(222)	(222)
Transactions with shareholders					
Shares issued	2,393	236,397	–	–	238,790
Share-based payment charge	–	–	222	–	222
As at 31 March 2025	2,393	236,397	222	(222)	238,790

Issued share capital

Issued share capital represents the nominal value of issued and fully paid shares, including both ordinary and priority shares. Details of the Company's issued share capital are provided in note 20 of the consolidated financial statements.

Share premium

Share premium comprises the excess of consideration received over the nominal value of shares issued, net of directly attributable transaction costs incurred in the issuance of those shares, including both ordinary and priority shares.

Other reserves

Other reserves represent the cumulative fair value of equity-settled share-based payments recognised in accordance with IFRS 2.

Retained earnings

Retained earnings represent the cumulative net profit or loss, as recognised in the consolidated statement of comprehensive income, net of dividends and other distributions.

Notes to the Company financial statements

1 General information and accounting policies

General information

Actium Topco (UK) Limited is a private company, limited by shares, incorporated in England and Wales with the registered number 15735478. Its registered office is 60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB, United Kingdom. The Company is a holding company, and its principal activity is to hold and manage investments in subsidiary companies.

Basis of preparation

The Company financial statements present information about the Company as a separate legal entity, rather than the consolidated Group, and have been prepared on a historical cost basis.

These financial statements have been prepared in accordance with FRS 101 *Reduced Disclosure Framework*. In preparing these financial statements, the Company applies the recognition, measurement and disclosure requirements of International Financial Reporting Standards ("IFRS") but makes amendments where necessary to comply with the Companies Act 2006.

The Company has taken advantage of the following disclosure exemptions available under FRS 101:

- The requirements of paragraphs 45(b) and 46 to 52 of IFRS 2 *Share-based Payment*
- The requirements of paragraphs 62, B64(d), B64(e), B64(g), B64(h), B64(j) to B64(m), B64(n)(ii), B64(o)(ii), B64(p), B64(q)(ii), B66 and B67 of IFRS 3 *Business Combinations*
- The requirements of IFRS 7 *Financial Instruments Disclosures*
- The requirements of paragraphs 10(d), 10(f), 16, 38A, 38B, 38C, 38D, 40A, 40B, 40C, 40D, 111 and 134 to 136 of IAS 1 *Presentation of Financial Statements*
- The requirements of paragraphs 1 to 63 of IAS 7 *Statement of Cash Flows*
- The requirements of paragraphs 17 and 18A of IAS 24 *Related Party Disclosures*
- The requirements in IAS 24 *Related Party Disclosures* to disclose related party transactions entered into between two or more members of a group
- The requirements of paragraphs 130(f)(ii), 130(f)(iii), 134(d) to 134(f) and 135(c) to 135(e) of IAS 36 *Impairment of Assets*

The presentational currency of these financial statements and the functional currency of the Company is pound sterling. All amounts presented have been rounded to the nearest £1,000, except where otherwise stated.

Going concern

The directors have a reasonable expectation that the Company has adequate resources to continue in existence for at least 12 months from the approval of these financial statements. Accordingly, the directors have adopted the going concern basis in preparing these financial statements. For further details, refer to note 1 of the consolidated financial statements.

Principal accounting policies

The principal accounting policies of the Company are consistent with those set out in note 1 of the consolidated financial statements, except in relation to investments in subsidiaries, which are accounted for at cost less provision for impairment. Acquisition accounting under IFRS 3 *Business Combinations* is not applied in the Company's separate financial statements.

Notes to the Company financial statements (continued)

1 General information and accounting policies (continued)

Significant judgements and estimates

The preparation of financial statements in accordance with IFRS requires management to make judgements, estimates, and assumptions that affect the application of accounting policies and the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, income, and expenses

The directors have not made any significant judgements, other than those involving estimations, in applying the Company's accounting policies that have had a material effect on the amounts recognised in the financial statements for the period ended 31 March 2025

The directors also consider that there are no key sources of estimation uncertainty that have a significant risk of resulting in a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities within the next financial year

New accounting standards and interpretations

Several standards, interpretations and amendments have been issued but were not mandatory for the current accounting period and have therefore not yet been adopted by the Company, as detailed in note 1 of the consolidated financial statements. None of these changes are expected to have a material impact on the Company financial statements

2. Investments

	Investments in subsidiaries £'000
Cost	
As at 22 May 2024	–
Additions	238,790
As at 31 March 2025	238,790

The addition to investments in subsidiaries in the year entirely relates to the purchase of shares in Actium Midco 1 (UK) Limited, which was financed by the issue of ordinary and priority shares in the period. This transaction was part of the funds flow to ultimately finance the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc by Actium Bidco (UK) Limited on 19 August 2024, as detailed in note 10 of the consolidated financial statements

The carrying amount of investments in subsidiaries was reviewed for impairment as at 31 March 2025, with reference to the value of the underlying trading group. No impairment was identified.

Information about related undertakings

In accordance with Section 409 of the Companies Act 2006, the following table sets out the subsidiary and associated undertakings in which the Group and the Company held an interest of 20% or more as at 31 March 2025. Actium Midco 1 (UK) Limited is a direct subsidiary of Actium (UK) Topco Limited. All other entities listed are indirect subsidiaries of the Company. The Group holds 100% of the issued share capital in each subsidiary undertaking, with all shares being ordinary (or an equivalent class).

Notes to the Company financial statements (continued)

2 Investments (continued)

Subsidiary undertaking	Country of incorporation	Registered address	Principal activity
Actium Bidco (UK) Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Actium Bidco (US), Ltd	USA	2	Holding company
Actium Holdings Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Actium Midco 1 (UK) Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Actium Midco 2 (UK) Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Actium Midco 3 (UK) Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Aiviq Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Alpha Alternatives Canada Ltd	Canada	3	Consultancy services
Alpha Data Solutions Limited	UK	1	Dormant
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting (Insurance) France S A S	France	4	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting (Luxembourg) S A	Luxembourg	5	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Australia Pty Limited	Australia	6	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Germany GmbH	Germany	7	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Group Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Hong Kong Limited	Hong Kong	8	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting MENA Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Netherlands B V	Netherlands	9	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting S A S	France	4	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Singapore Pte Ltd	Singapore	10	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting Switzerland S A	Switzerland	11	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting UK Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Alpha Financial Markets Consulting, Inc	USA	12	Consultancy services
Alpha FM Consulting Canada Inc	Canada	13	Consultancy services
Alpha FMC Alternatives Consulting GmbH	Germany	14	Consultancy services
Alpha FMC Bidco Limited	UK	1	Holding company
Alpha FMC Group Nominees Ltd	UK	1	Dormant
Alpha FMC Middle East LLC	Qatar	15	Consultancy services
Alpha FMC Trustee Limited	UK	1	Dormant
Alpha Technology Services Consulting Limited	UK	1	Dormant
Alpha Technology Services S A S	France	4	Dormant
Axxsys Consulting USA, Inc	USA	16	Dormant
Axxsys Danmark ApS	Denmark	17	Consultancy services
Axxsys Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Bankside Asia Pte Ltd	Singapore	18	Consultancy services
Bankside Cloud Technology Ltd	UK	1	Consultancy services
Bankside Financial Solutions Consulting Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Bankside Payroll Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Lionpoint Group (UK) Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
Lionpoint Group Pty Limited	Australia	19	Consultancy services
Lionpoint Group S A	Switzerland	20	Consultancy services
Lionpoint Group, LLC	USA	2	Consultancy services
Lionpoint Holdings, Inc	USA	2	Holding company
Obsidian Alpha Data Solutions LLC Belgrade	Serbia	21	Consultancy services
Obsidian Solutions Ltd	UK	1	Consultancy services
Shoreline Consolidated Pty Ltd	Australia	22	Consultancy services
Shoreline Consulting Pte Ltd	Singapore	23	Consultancy services
Shoreline Consulting Pty Ltd	Australia	22	Consultancy services
White Marble Consulting Limited	UK	1	Consultancy services
White Marble Consulting, Inc	USA	24	Consultancy services
White Marble Group Limited	UK	1	Holding company

Notes to the Company financial statements (continued)

2 Investments (continued)

Registered addresses

- 1 60 Gresham Street, London, EC2V 7BB
- 2 251, Little Falls Drive, Wilmington, New Castle, Delaware, 19808, United States of America
- 3 1800-13401, 108th Avenue, Surrey, British Columbia, V3T 5T3, Canada
- 4 6, Square de l'Opera Louis Jouvet, 75009 Paris, France
- 5 19/21, Route d'Arlon - Bloc B, Strassen, L-8009, Luxembourg
- 6 Quay Quarter Tower, 50 Bridge Street, Sydney, NSW 2000
- 7 Kurt-Blaum-Platz 8, Hanau, 63450, Germany
- 8 22/F, Neich Tower, 128 Gloucester Road, Wanchai, Hong Kong
- 9 331A, Haarlemmerweg, 1051LH Amsterdam, Netherlands
- 10 6A Shenton Way, #04-01 Downtown Gallery, Singapore, 068815, Singapore
- 11 55, Stockerstrasse, Zürich, 8002, Switzerland
- 12 437, Madison Avenue, Suite 3202, New York, New York, 10022, United States of America
- 13 Suite 1700, Park Place, 666 Burrard Street, Vancouver, BC V6C2X8, Canada
- 14 16-18, Große Gallusstraße, Frankfurt am Main, 60312, Germany
- 15 C/o TMF Group LLC, Office No 506, Floor No 5, Y Tower, Street No 305, Area No 69, Al Edd Al Sharqi Street, Doha, Qatar
- 16 Incorp Services Inc, 919 North Market Street, Suite 950, Wilmington, DE 19801, United States of America
- 17 Flaesketoeriet 68, Copenhagen, DK-1711, Denmark
- 18 10, Anson Road, #22-02 International Plaza, 079903, Singapore
- 19 Ground Floor, 123 Walker Street, North Sydney, NSW 2060, Australia
- 20 11, Rue d'Italie, Geneva, 1204, Switzerland
- 21 Dvadesetsedmog marta 6-6a, Belgrade, 11060 Palilula, Serbia
- 22 Accru Felters Level 6, 1 Chifley Square, Sydney, NSW 2000 Australia
- 23 Marina Bay Financial Centre, 8 Marina Boulevard #11-00, 018981 Singapore
- 24 205, Portland Street, C/O WeWork, Boston, MA, 02114 United States of America

3 Auditor's remuneration

Information on fees payable to the Company's auditor and its associates is disclosed on a consolidated basis in note 3 of the consolidated financial statements

4. Share capital

Disclosures in relation to the Company's share capital, including information on each class of share, are included in note 20 of the consolidated financial statements

5. Share-based payments

During the period, in January 2025, the Company implemented a new management incentive plan ("MIP") to retain and incentivise certain members of the Group's senior management following the acquisition of Alpha Financial Markets Consulting plc. A share-based payment charge of £0.2m has been recognised in the Company's accounts in period in relation to the MIP. Disclosures in relation to share-based payments are included in note 21 of the consolidated financial statements.

6 Related party transactions

The Company has not engaged in any transactions with any related parties, other than with wholly owned subsidiaries and key management personnel. These transactions have not been disclosed as the Company has taken advantage of disclosure exemptions under FRS 101. Related party transactions for the Group are disclosed in note 24 of the consolidated financial statements.